



# INSPIRE

Investing in Neighborhoods and Schools to Promote  
Improvement, Revitalization, and Excellence

## *Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School*

# INSPIRE PLAN



March 2017



*Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School*  
**INSPIRE PLAN**



Adopted by the  
Baltimore City Planning Commission  
March 23, 2017

Published  
March 2017

# *Letter from the Director*

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Greetings,

It is with great pleasure that I share the Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School INSPIRE plan. I want to express sincere thanks to the many residents and community stakeholders who played a role in shaping this plan, and for their commitment to working in partnership with the City to make their neighborhood a great place to live. INSPIRE plans are created through a collaboration with many stakeholder partners including neighborhood residents, organizations, businesses, and developers; the philanthropic community; anchor institutions; City agencies; and more. Together we are maximizing the impact around the modernized schools being built around Baltimore so that when the doors open for students on their first day, there will be a noticeable difference in the neighborhood surrounding the new 21st Century facility.

Every division of the Department of Planning has been involved either in developing the INSPIRE plan or in supporting the 21st Century School process. From offering urban design, architecture, and landscape design expertise, to identifying opportunities to increase access to healthy food or to secure a site and funding resources for a community garden, my team has been committed to working with others to develop the highest-quality school facilities and INSPIRE recommendations that will strengthen the connection between each school and its surrounding neighborhood.

Our commitment doesn't end here. INSPIRE plans provide a roadmap for achieving longer-term goals around housing, environmental sustainability, safety, sanitation, transportation, and health. We will continue to work with our partners – public agencies, institutions, businesses, non-profits, philanthropy, neighborhood organizations and residents – to achieve holistic progress towards the community's aspirations. New and improved school facilities both improve quality of life for existing students and families, and serve as catalysts for attracting new residents to Baltimore neighborhoods. INSPIRE plans like this one aim to capture that potential. We welcome new ideas and partnerships to help us achieve that goal.

Sincerely,



Thomas J. Stosur  
Director of Planning  
City of Baltimore

# Acknowledgments

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The Lyndhurst Elementary Middle School INSPIRE Plan was created by the Baltimore City Department of Planning, but is the result of a collaborative process involving significant community and City agency input. Kyle Leggs, Southwest Planner, led the creation of this plan with support from Jennifer Leonard, INSPIRE Program Manager. Additional Department of Planning support came from Aaron Bond, Elina Bravve, Michael Galdi, and Reni Lawal. The Department of Planning thanks everyone who attended workshops, shared their ideas, and provided support.

*Special thanks go to:*

Mayor Catherine E. Pugh  
Former Mayor Stephanie Rawlings-Blake  
Councilwoman Helen Holton  
Councilman Kristerfer Burnett

The Lyndhurst Elementary scholars, their parents, and school leadership and faculty for their dedication to making the school and community thrive. Many thanks as well to Rognel Heights Elementary Middle School community in Rognel Heights, who were important participants in the INSPIRE planning process, and champions for their community's children.

The many residents and stakeholders from the Lyndhurst, Edmondson Village, Edgewood, Rognel Heights, and Allendale neighborhoods who shared their vision and recommendations for their community. There were also a number of community leaders and institutions essential in guiding the recommendations in this Plan. These include church leaders at the New Covenant Worship Center, St. Bernardine's Catholic Church, Connexion Point Church, Central Church of Christ, and Go-Northwest's Healthy Neighborhoods Community Liaison. These individuals and institutions are the pillars of this community and have a vested interest in the overall revitalization and stabilization of this community.

The Family League and the University of Maryland School of Social Work (SWCOS) for their involvement to help strengthen capacity, connections, and community school opportunities.

*Thank you to these City agencies who were key partners in developing this plan.*

Baltimore City Mayor's Office  
Baltimore City Department of Housing and Community Development  
Baltimore City Department of Public Works  
Baltimore City Department of Recreation and Parks  
Baltimore City Department of Transportation  
Baltimore City Public Schools System  
Baltimore Development Corporation

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# *Overview and Introduction*

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## **21st Century School Buildings Program**

### **21st Century School Buildings Renovation/Replacement – Phase I**

### **INSPIRE Mission and Objectives**

### **INSPIRE Process**



## 21st Century School Buildings Program

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In the fall of 2010, groundwork was laid to address Baltimore City's aging and inadequate public school buildings. Community, education advocacy groups, the school system, and other stakeholders built a coalition of support for legislation and funding to modernize all of Baltimore's public schools. The promise of replaced and renovated schools is meant to help transform student opportunities and achievement, provide jobs and resources to families, and help revitalize neighborhoods.

The 21st Century School Buildings Program (the Program) will support excellence in teaching and learning with flexible and adaptable space, learning areas designed for interaction and collaboration, and technology-equipped classrooms, enabling students to meet today's—and tomorrow's—high standards, and will provide communities with a shared public resource that will enrich their neighborhoods. Baltimore City will benefit for decades to come from this historic effort to provide the healthy, safe, efficient, and modern school buildings all children deserve. As a result, students in Baltimore City Public Schools will benefit from:

- Replaced or renovated school buildings across the city;
- School environments that support teaching and learning to prepare students for college and career success;
- Schools that become hubs of resources supporting entire communities;
- Modern, efficient, and inspiring educational facilities that also provide recreation and community use; and
- Partnerships that encourage businesses and neighborhood residents to connect with their local schools.

All of the major renovation and replacement projects in the Program will meet or exceed U.S. Green Building Council's LEED-Silver standard. LEED stands for Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design; LEED-certified buildings are resource-efficient and save operating costs. Each school design team works with a sustainability consultant, to ensure certification.

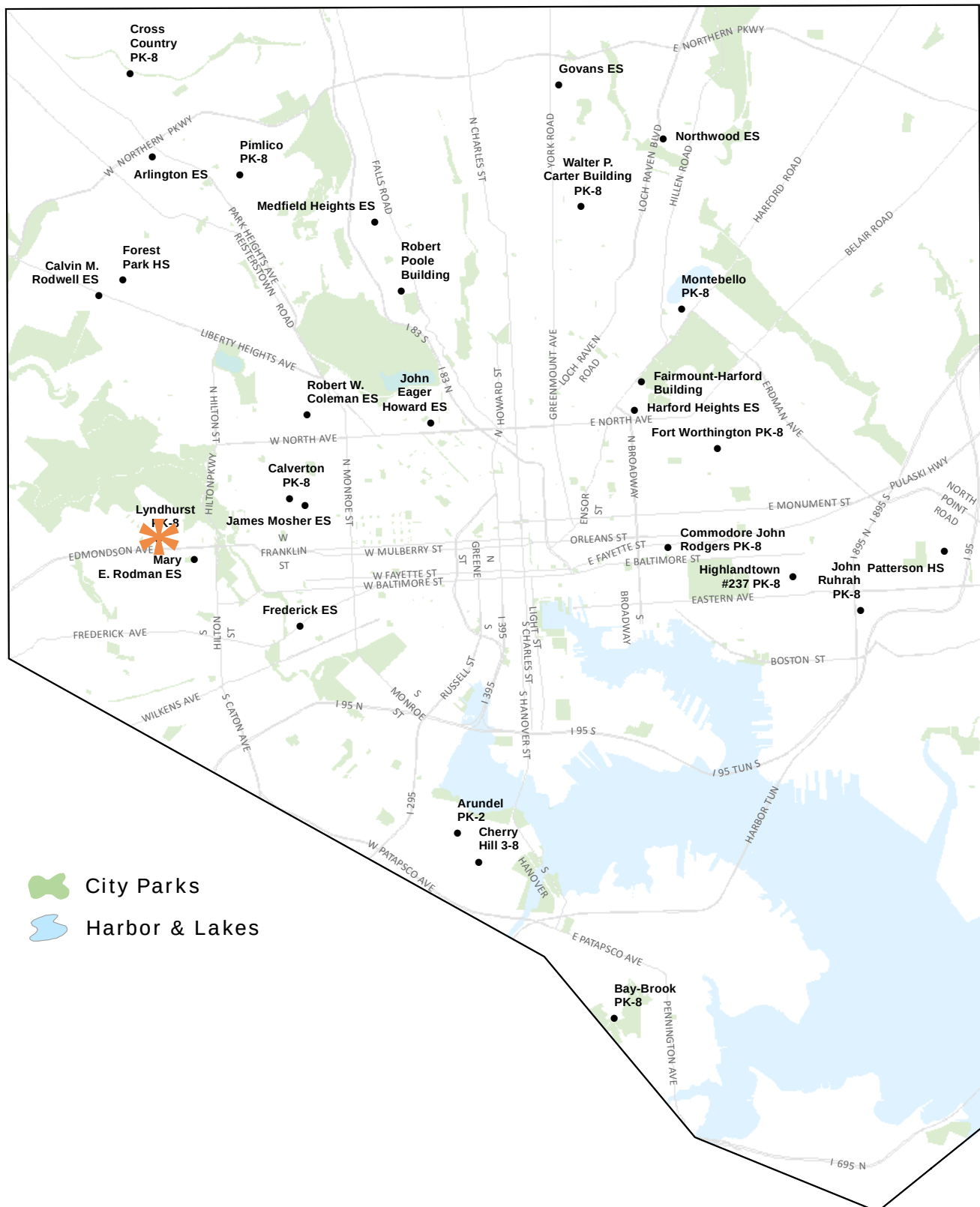
### **Financing and Administering the Program**

The Baltimore City Public School System Construction and Revitalization Act of 2013 resulted in a partnership between the City of Baltimore, the State of Maryland, and Baltimore City Public Schools, financing a program that is leveraging \$60 million/year to provide approximately \$1 billion in bond proceeds for school construction issued by the Maryland Stadium Authority. Additionally, The City of Baltimore, Baltimore City Public Schools, the Interagency Committee on Public School Construction, and Maryland Stadium Authority are partnering through a Memorandum of Understanding in order to manage and oversee the plan.

School construction is typically funded by municipalities and states on a project-by-project basis. Alternative financing for school construction using this method for the Program allows Baltimore City Public Schools to expedite the process of significantly renovating or replacing 23-28 school buildings over a seven year period.

*Find out more about 21st Century Schools Building Program, partnerships, school project statuses, community engagement, job/contract opportunities, and more at <http://baltimore21stcenturyschools.org>.*

# 21st Century School Buildings Renovation/Replacement – Phase 1





## INSPIRE Mission and Objectives

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Each modernized 21st Century school represents tens of millions of dollars of public investment into the neighborhood it serves.

To leverage this investment, and to enhance the connection between the schools and the surrounding neighborhoods, the Department of Planning launched a new program called INSPIRE, which stands for Investing in Neighborhoods and Schools to Promote Improvement, Revitalization, and Excellence. This planning program focuses on the neighborhoods surrounding each of the schools, specifically the quarter-mile around the schools.

### Focusing on a Quarter-Mile

Focusing on a limited geographic area allows plans to concentrate impact around the school so that assets and investments support the school as a community resource, build on each other, and continue to expand further into the neighborhood. Recommendations in the plan don't simply stop at a quarter-mile marker; a guiding principle however, is concentration of resources and impact. In this way, the INSPIRE plans respond to the aspirations of the neighborhood and school stakeholders in a way that is achievable.

### Making an Impact

INSPIRE plans seek to lead to improvements in the



environment and in the quality of life for students, their families, and neighborhood residents and businesses. The plans will also articulate the community's long-term vision for guiding private investment, and address environmental, social, and economic conditions.

To achieve this, there are two categories of recommendations.

- To strengthen the connection between the school and community, the first set of recommendations focuses on blocks that have been designated as "primary walking routes." Standard improvements along these routes will help ensure that students and other community members have safer and more walkable access to the school. See page 27 for details.
- To address environmental, social, and economic conditions, and to help guide future investment, the second set of recommendations is divided into six goals. While all INSPIRE plans start with the same goals, community stakeholders help prioritize them; strategies and recommendations are developed in response to their input.
  - Invest in housing and neighborhood market-strengthening development opportunities

- Improve safety
- Improve sanitation
- Create environmentally-sustainable neighborhoods
- Create opportunities for health and wellness
- Create connections and access

### **Implementing the Plans**

Implementing recommendations that have been developed in partnership with community stakeholders is arguably the most important step. Throughout the planning process, the Department of Planning has met with City agencies, neighborhood stakeholders, and others who are critical partners in ensuring that recommendations become reality.

City agencies and others have committed to start making improvements by allocating staffing resources and capital dollars, and the Department of Planning is using General Obligation Bond funding (currently five million dollars for Fiscal Year 2016 and Fiscal Year 2017) to support improvements along the primary walking routes and community-selected projects. In some cases, recommendations highlight efforts already happening, or suggest programmatic partnerships. In others, stakeholders can decide to organize neighbors to implement a recommendation. Full implementation of the plans requires the engagement of the private market, anchor institutions, and the philanthropic community. The plans provide clear priorities to guide that investment.

Pages 46-51 contains implementation tables for all of the recommendations, and shows commitments that have already been made.

## INSPIRE Process

The Planning Department works with community members, school stakeholders, City agencies, citywide organizations, and others to guide the INSPIRE process. Throughout the process we LISTEN, CREATE, and DELIVER.

- **LISTEN: Gathering Information**

Community stakeholders, Department of Planning staff, and other City agency staff examine existing conditions around the school and identify strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities. The Department of Planning reviews neighborhood history and plans, collects demographic data, conducts walking tours with an INSPIRE Steering Committee, convenes workshops, and conducts surveys to gather information from stakeholders.

- **CREATE: Drafting and Reviewing Recommendations**

Based on stakeholder input, Department of Planning staff drafts recommendations. Relevant City agency representatives will help identify where agencies can coordinate. Draft recommendations are shared with stakeholders, and are revised and prioritized.

- **DELIVER: Writing, Reviewing, and Executing the Plan**

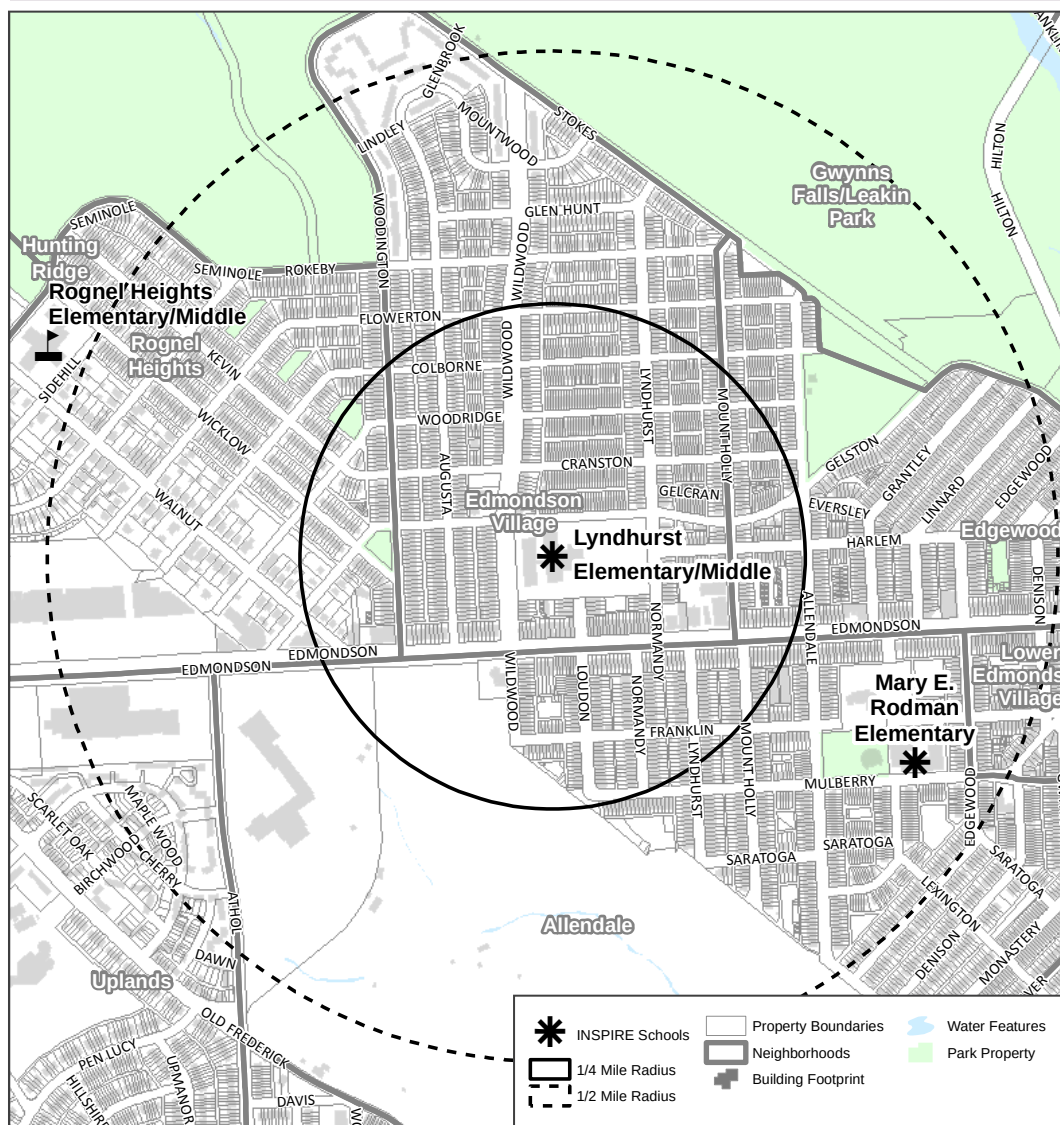
Department of Planning staff write the INSPIRE plan and share it with the community. After the plan is reviewed by the community, it is submitted to the Planning Commission for adoption.

This chart depicts the general process flow, although each planning process is unique.



# INSPIRE Planning Area Background

Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School #88 is located at 621 Wildwood Parkway in West Baltimore. The quarter-mile INSPIRE radius contains several neighborhoods, collectively known as “Edmondson Village.” The area is predominantly made up of Edmondson Village, Lyndhurst, and Allendale, but also includes Rognel Heights and Edgewood. In addition to the modernization of Lyndhurst, other area schools will be affected by Phase 1 of the 21st Century program. Rognel Heights Elementary/Middle School #89 is scheduled to close and its students will be zoned for Lyndhurst. Mary E. Rodman Elementary School, located southeast of Lyndhurst, is also slated for modernization.



## Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School Modernization

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Lyndhurst Elementary School #88 is being renovated and expanded, and will become the Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School.

Students attending Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School for the 2017-2018 school year will occupy one of the first 21st Century school buildings to re-open as part of the program. The project, which will preserve and renovate the original 1926 wing, was designed by STV USA Architects and is being constructed by Turner-JLN Construction Services, LLC. Wings B and C, constructed in 1951 and 1980, will be replaced. The school building and site improvements represent a \$40 million investment in the community.

The modernized school building and site will be different from the old school in many ways. Flexible and adaptable space, learning areas designed for interaction and collaboration, and technology-equipped classrooms will be featured. Below are some of the highlights:

- The new building will be significantly larger than the old building – going from approximately 50,728 sf to 110,355 sf, with a significant increase in capacity from approximately 300 students to 714.
- The educational program at Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School will serve students from pre-kindergarten through 8th grade.
- To preserve the school’s historic character, the original 1926 building will be maintained and renovated, while the two additions will be replaced by new construction offering numerous classrooms and flexible spaces designed with 21st century learning in mind. Flow within the building will ensure efficient use of space while maintaining distinct areas for older and younger learners, and common spaces will be enlarged to accommodate a larger student population and access for community use in out-of-school hours.
- To make the school available as a public resource to be shared with partners, the neighboring community, there will be a controlled school-partner access and separate community entrances open during designated times.
- The new main entrance to the school will be on the side of the school facing the south, and will include a new student drop-off and pickup zone.



# School Rendering and Site Plan

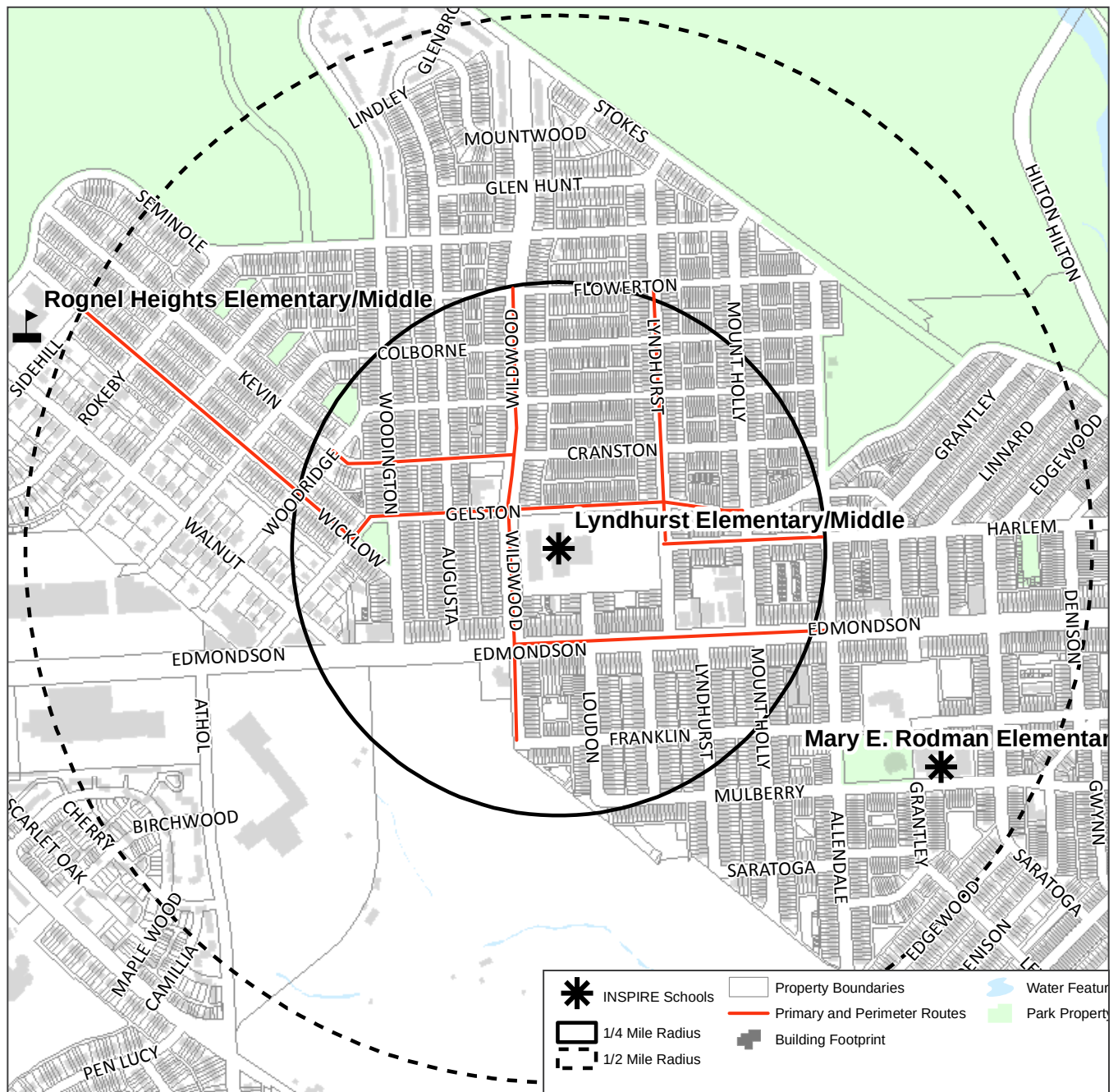




## Primary Routes to School

The map below identifies the perimeters around Lyndhurst and the primary routes leading to the school. The main walking routes used by students to travel to and from the school were identified as Wicklow

Road, Wildwood Parkway, Gelston Drive, Edmondson Avenue, Kevin Road to Cranston Avenue, Lyndhurst Avenue, and Harlem Avenue.





## Neighborhood History

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The neighborhoods that make up Edmondson Village today (Lyndhurst, Edmondson Village, Edgewood, Lower Edmondson Village, Allendale, Rognel Heights, and Uplands) are typical of Baltimore's rowhouse neighborhoods. Until the early part of the 20th century the area was considered suburban, and was comprised of gentlemen country estates, small truck farms, and buildings that served the industries located along the nearby Gwynns Falls. Growth began when electric street car service began in 1899, and a new bridge over the Gwynns Falls was built in 1910. Edmondson Village saw its largest increase in population and housing development between 1910 and 1930, with much of it occurring in the 1920s. Beginning in 1916, rowhouse developer James Keelty began buying property west of the Gwynns Falls and north and south of Edmondson Avenue. In 1926 he acquired the entire Gelston Estate, and in 1928 purchased the Lyndhurst estate. These purchases made up most of the area we know as Edmondson Village. Between the late 1940s and early 1950s, the northern section of the neighborhood was developed by Keelty and other developers. By the early 1950s Edmondson Village was completely built out.

A number of churches were built in the area; the first was St. Bernardine's Roman Catholic Church, built in 1928-1929. Over the next two decades came commercial and entertainment development, with two movie theaters (the Edgewood in 1930 at 3500 Edmondson Avenue, and Edmondson Village in 1948 at 4428 Edmondson Avenue) and the Edmondson Village Shopping Center in 1947. The shopping center was one of the nation's first large-scale shopping attractions with multiple stores and a movie theatre. Shopping malls did not exist before the 1950s and in Baltimore the only other shopping centers were in Roland Park and downtown.

Until the 1950s, residents of Edmondson Village were mostly white. Between 1955 and 1965, the neighborhood changed to predominately African American, largely as a result of "Blockbusting" techniques. Through fear tactics, white homeowners were persuaded to sell their houses to real estate developers at a very low cost. The realtor/developer then flipped the houses to African American families at exorbitant prices. Despite the destabilizing effects of blockbusting, by 1970 Edmondson Village had a higher homeownership rate than most neighborhoods in Baltimore.

Many prominent politicians attended the original Lyndhurst School, built in 1926. Alumni include former Mayor and Governor William Donald Schaefer (who grew up in the Edgewood community), and U.S. Congressman Elijah Cummings. The New Cathedral Cemetery, established in 1869, is where Baltimore's first African American Mayor, Clarence H. "Du" Burns, is buried.

Most of the Edmondson Village neighborhood meets the standards for both local and national historic district designation. In August 2016 Baltimore's Commission for Historical and Architectural Preservation (CHAP) voted to nominate Edmondson Village as a National Historic District. The application is being considered by the National Park Service. If designated, property owners would be eligible for local, state, and federal historic tax credits for rehabilitation work. See page 56 for a map of the proposed district.

This history was informed by *Blockbusting in Baltimore: The Edmondson Village Story* by W. Edward Orser

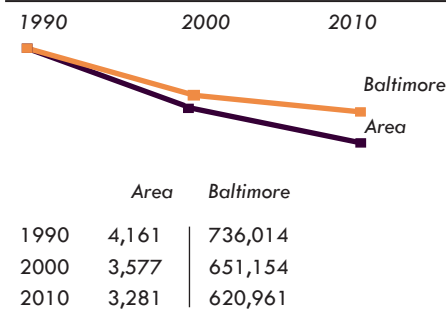
## Key City and Neighborhood Data



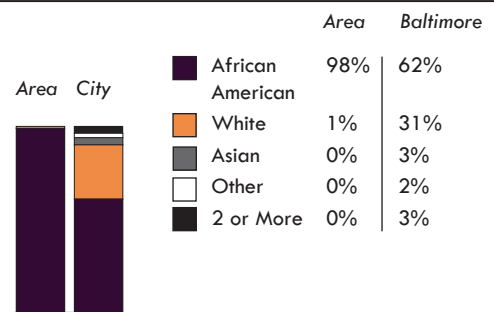
The charts below depict data from the Census Tracts highlighted in this map (Census Tracts 1608.1). Source: U.S. Census Bureau 2011-2015 American Community Survey (area data) and 1-year American Community Survey (City data).

Figures may not sum to 100 percent due to rounding.

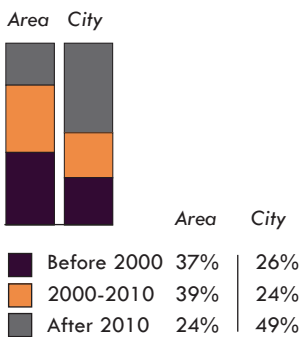
### Population Change



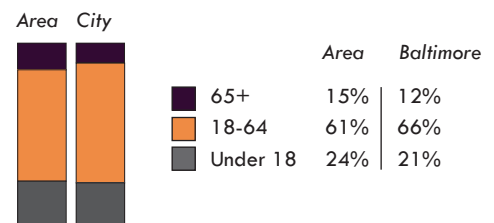
### Race



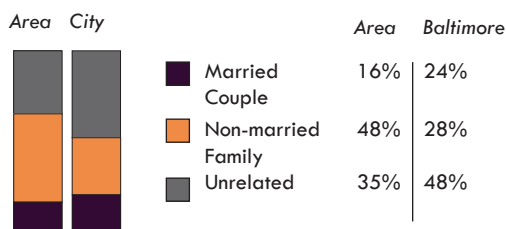
### Residence Established



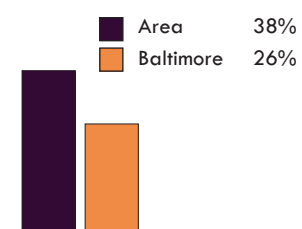
### Age



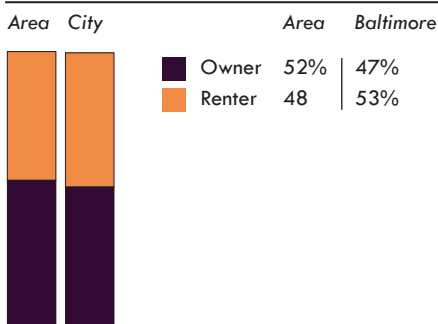
### Household Structure



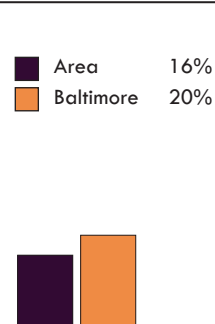
### Households with Children



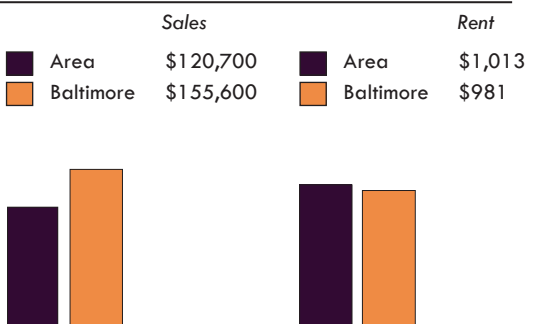
### Housing Occupancy



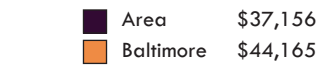
### Average Vacancy Rate



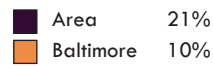
### Mean Housing Sales and Rent



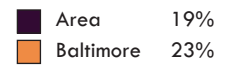
## Median Income



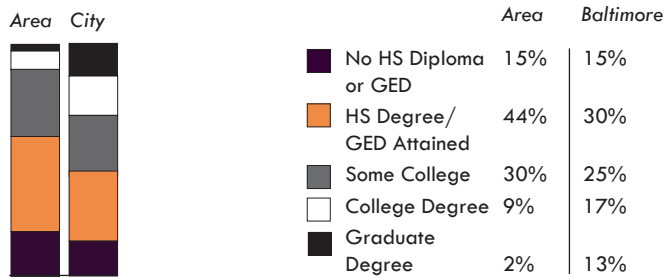
## Unemployment Rate



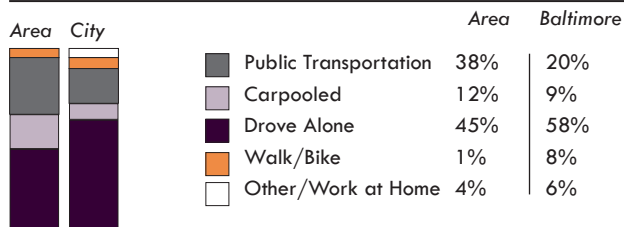
## Poverty Rate



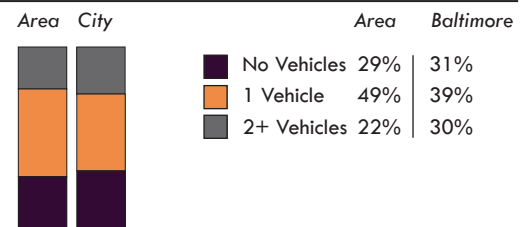
## Educational Attainment



## Journey to Work



## Vehicle Availability



## Percentage of Population Living in a Food Desert



## Neighborhood Observations

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### Housing and Land Use

Edmondson Village is primarily a residential neighborhood, and the majority of housing consists of two-story row house units with front and back yards. A large 262-unit, 3-story apartment complex at the northernmost part of the neighborhood, the Wildwood Garden Apartments, was built in 1950. In 2008, the Uplands community – of which a small part is in the southwest corner of the INSPIRE area – began to undergo significant revitalization with the demolition of 979 vacant apartments to make way for the development and construction of a multi-phase 761 affordable and market-rate mixed income housing project, to include rental properties. The groundbreaking took place in 2010, and as of 2017, 178 of the homes are occupied or available for sale. Construction phases will continue over approximately the next five years.

Much of the area directly surrounding the school is stable, with a homeownership rate slightly higher than the city's. According to the Census, over 76% of the residents have lived in the neighborhood since at least 2010, and 37% have lived there for at least 15 years. There are some vacant buildings scattered throughout the INSPIRE area that need immediate attention. Slightly higher concentrations of vacancies can be seen south of Edmondson Avenue and east of the school. Much of the neighborhood falls into what the City's Housing Market Typology calls "middle" markets. See Appendix A for the Housing Market Typology map of the area.

In 2008, the communities of Edmondson Village, Lyndhurst, and Edgewood became part of the Healthy Neighborhoods program. Together they established an Edmondson Village Healthy Neighborhoods Collaborative. The Collaborative initially had an office in

the community, but fiscal constraints led the office to close. The Healthy Neighborhood liaison now operates out of the Go-Northwest Housing Resource Center located in Garwyn Oaks. Healthy Neighborhoods is a vital program in the neighborhood, providing home improvement loans, investment incentives, support for purchases and sales of homes in the area, and grants for neighborhood improvements such as street planters and community signs.

The Edmondson Village Shopping Center, which is located one-half mile to the west of the school, meets some of the retail needs of the community, however, the quality of stores and services has declined over the years, and many residents go outside of the neighborhood to shop. Community groups have noted that better maintenance, landscaping, and improvements to the shopping center such as new signage and storefront façades, along with new tenants, would make it more appealing to residents.

Decades ago, the neighborhoods that make up Edmondson Village contained a number of corner retail establishments that provided needed services to the community. These included small groceries, bakeries, delis, shoe repair shops, television repair shops, and barber shops and/or beauty salons. Today, however, some of the retail businesses in these residentially-zoned spaces don't serve the needs of the community. Several stores are uninviting, blighted, sell alcohol, and are known for loitering, trash, drug sales, and other crimes. Few stores offer healthy food.

### Recreation and Open Space

Edmondson Village is well-served by natural and recreational assets. Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School is located a few blocks south of the Gwynns

Falls Leakin Park, one of the largest urban parks in the country. This is one of the most significant assets to the community and enhances the public realm. The widely-used Gwynns Falls Trail is also located in the park and provides a significant amenity for hiking and biking. Currently, the outer park area provides recreational space for basketball, softball, exercise, play areas for pets, and natural open space. The Edgewood/Lyndhurst Recreation Center, located just over one-quarter mile to the northeast of the school, provides a number of recreational activities and spaces including indoor activities and games, basketball, a playground, and a large field that supports youth football and other sports.

### **Transportation**

Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School is located one block north of Edmondson Avenue, a major east/west thoroughfare. It is also within a short commute to I-70, I-695, and I-95. The area is served by multiple bus lines including the #23, #38, and #40. The neighborhood is located less than two miles from the Baltimore county line to the west. It is also relatively close to downtown Baltimore by way of the Franklin and Mulberry Street corridors. Driving or taking public transportation to get downtown or to the suburbs is relatively easy.

Vehicular access to and from the northern two-thirds of the INSPIRE area is limited because of one-way streets and the natural barrier of the park to the north. This means that vehicular access is primarily along Edmondson Avenue, which is both a high-volume thoroughfare and a primary way children walk to and from the school. Pedestrian safety, therefore, is particularly important along Edmondson Avenue. The Edmondson Avenue Bridge over the Gwynns Falls is under renovation, and when completed in 2020, will provide a new and improved appearance to the corridor.

### **Community Involvement**

There are several communities that surround Lyndhurst Elementary/ Middle School and they all have active community associations. Regular meetings typically include elected officials and representatives from City agencies to talk about city services. These are the action organizations:

- The Lyndhurst Community Association
- The Edmondson Village Community Association
- The Rognel Heights Community Association
- The Edgewood Neighborhood Improvement Association (TENIA)
- The Allendale Community Association
- Southwest Better Neighbors
- The Uplands Community Association



## Existing Plans and Initiatives

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A number of plans and planning processes have taken place in the neighborhoods surrounding Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School. The INSPIRE plan has been informed by two of these efforts in particular: The Edmondson Village Area Master Plan, and the Red Line planning process.

### **The Edmondson Village Area Master Plan (adopted in 2007)**

This plan focuses primarily on community revitalization and building on existing strengths – including the Gwynns Falls Leakin Park, neighborhood schools, churches, community leaders, and the history of the community. Some recommendations, such as creating a community school in the area, have been accomplished (Lyndhurst is a community school). A number of recommendations, however, are still awaiting implementation. These include improvements to retail sites and services, landmark designation for eligible properties, housing revitalization, sanitation improvements, and beautification along the edge of the Gwynns Falls Park.

### **Red Line planning process (2011)**

Area residents participated in a major planning effort to identify neighborhood improvements as part of the proposed Baltimore Red Line Light Rail Transit System along the Edmondson Avenue Corridor. Proposed improvements included landscaping, tree plantings, sidewalk improvements, and neighborhood-branded signage and art. Residents still would like to see these improvements made.

### **Baltimore Uplands Area Retail Market Analysis (2009)**

This analysis examined existing and potential retail goods and related services provided in the Uplands area, including the Edmondson Village Shopping Center and the surrounding Edmondson Village communities – extending east to Hilton Street and west to the city-county line. Key findings include:

- There were retail “gaps,” including for women’s and men’s clothing and shoes, and a full-service restaurant
- There was an over-representation of certain retail uses including fast food shops; beer, wine and liquor stores; and cosmetic/beauty stores
- There was a preponderance of retail activity west of the community in Baltimore County that drew residents to purchase what they needed there
- The purchasing power and demand was greater than the products and services provided
- Development and investment could enhance the retail and commercial sector to meet the demand and keep dollars in the community

# *INSPIRE Recommendations*

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## **Plan Development and Overview**

### **Standard Improvements – Primary Walking Routes**

### **Goals, Strategies, and Recommendations – Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School Planning Area**

## Plan Development and Overview

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Between October 2014 and February 2017, Department of Planning (DOP) staff met with over 150 members of the Lyndhurst and Rognel Heights school communities (principals, staff, parents, and students), along with residents in the Edmondson Village, Edgewood, and Allendale neighborhoods to better understand their neighborhood experiences, concerns, and needs. Through a combination of the workshops, community meetings, surveys, and walking tours, numerous other community leaders and stakeholders have helped inform the recommendations presented here.

The DOP held two workshops with community members and other stakeholders to examine the strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities of the area.

- DOP facilitated student workshops at Lyndhurst Elementary School in January 2015 and at Rognel Heights in March 2015. 41 students participated.
- DOP administered 33 surveys to parents, family members, and teachers during student pick-up and drop-off in front of Lyndhurst Elementary and Rognel Heights Elementary/Middle School, and conducted 10 stakeholder interviews. The survey was also distributed at community meetings and available online.
- Residents volunteered to participate in an INSPIRE Steering Committee (previously called the CORE Team) to help DOP staff target, guide, and prioritize specific improvements in the community for inclusion in the Plan. These Steering Committee members also played a

significant role by identifying areas to target for improvements during walking tours.

- DOP conducted walking tours with members of the Steering Committee on August 2015 that included walks of the larger Edmondson Village and Allendale community.
- In April 2015, DOP staff participated in meetings with the Family League’s Community Engagement Specialist, school Principal, parent group representatives, teachers, support staff, community representatives, and staff from the University of Maryland School of Social Work to create an “Action Plan” for Community School implementation.
- In June 2016, DOP shared the Draft INSPIRE Recommendation Report with representatives from the school and neighborhood, elected officials, and stakeholder organizations at community meetings that included church leaders, representatives from Neighbors without Borders, Southwest Better Neighbors, and staff at the Edgewood/Lyndhurst Recreation Center. These stakeholders also provided feedback to inform the final plan.

Staff from City agencies, including the Baltimore City Police Department, Baltimore Development Corporation, Department of Housing and Community Development, Department of Public Works, Department of Recreation and Parks, and Department of Transportation participated in the tours, and/or field visits.

## Standard Improvements – Primary Walking Routes

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Ensuring that students and other community members have safe and attractive pedestrian access to the school is critical to strengthening the connection between the school and community. Therefore, one part of each INSPIRE plan is a focus on the blocks that have been designated as the “primary walking routes.” See page 15 for the primary routes map.

The Department of Planning used BCPS student/school zone data, and worked with community members, school staff, and crossing guards, and the Department of Transportation, to identify the predominant routes that students use to get to and from the

school. Within the ¼-mile INSPIRE planning area, blocks on these routes have been designated as the primary walking routes. These blocks are being prioritized for consistent streetscape improvements that will occur prior to the school reopening. They have also been designated as Safe Routes to School routes, and will be marked with the City’s Safe Routes to School wayfinding footprints.

Through commitments from many City agencies, these key improvements will be made along the primary walking routes:

- Bringing sidewalks up to a safe and standard condition
- Repainting or adding crosswalks
- Assessing the need for repairs to ADA ramps at intersections
- Marking Safe Routes to School footprints
- Assessing crossing guard deployment
- Pruning and planting street trees
- Assessing street lighting
- Boarding open vacant buildings
- Picking up trash and maintaining vacant lots

The Implementation Table on page 46 provides additional details.

## **Goals, Strategies, and Recommendations – Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School Planning Area**

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The recommendations presented in the remainder of this report are in addition to those that address the issues along the school perimeter and primary routes listed on page 15. Many recommendations described could easily fit under more than one goal.

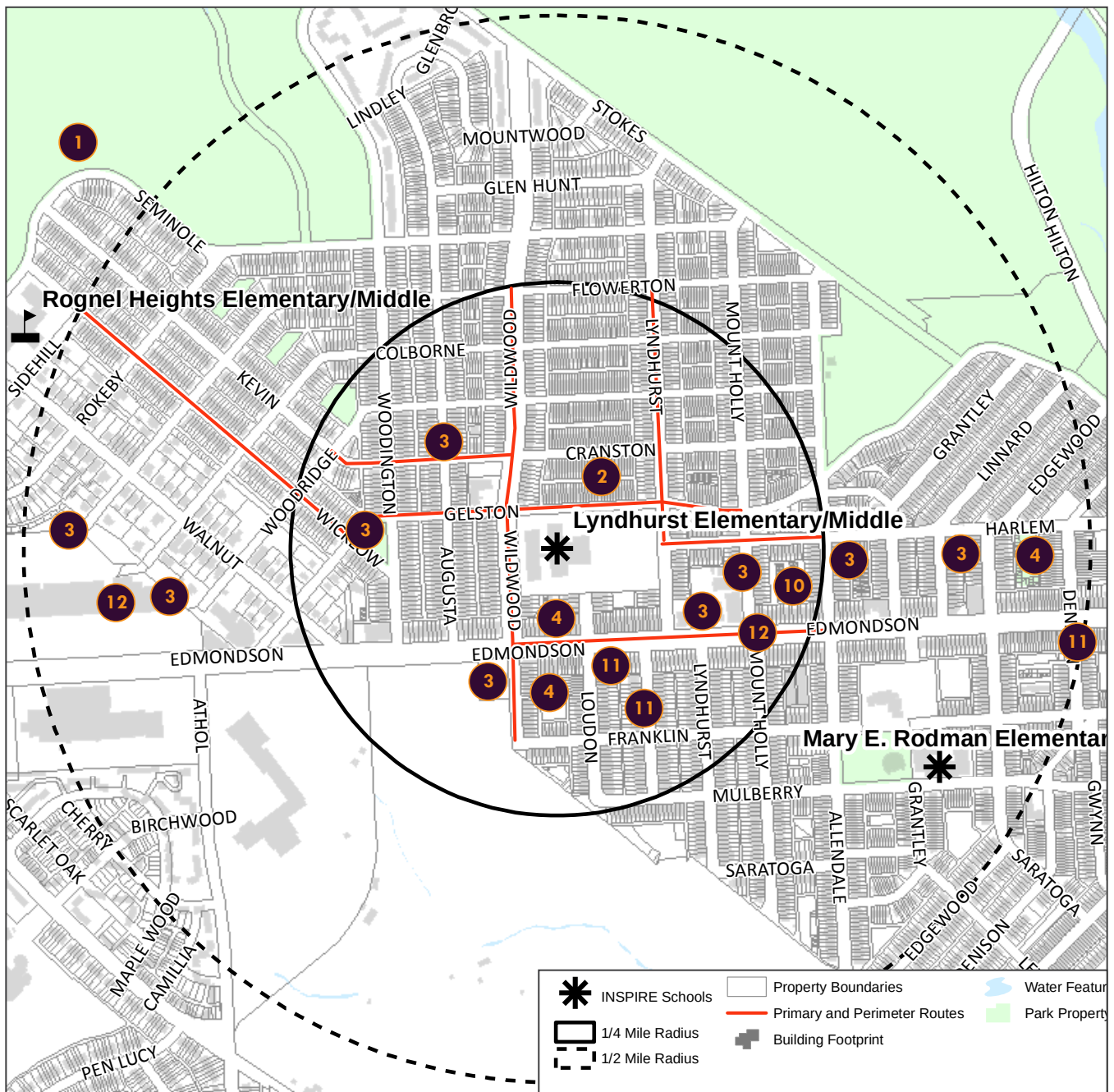
Recommendations for the Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School Planning Area, fall under these goals and strategies:

- Invest in Housing and Market-Strengthening Development Opportunities
  - Identify and Support Strategic Redevelopment Opportunities
  - Create and Maintain High-Quality, Affordable Housing for Rent and Sale
  - Support and Increase Homeownership
  - Remove Blight
  - Improve Retail Businesses and Seek Quality Entrepreneurs in the Community
- Create Environmentally-Sustainable Neighborhoods
  - Beautify Highly-visible Public Spaces
  - Contribute to the Green Network through Lot Restoration
- Create Opportunities for Health and Wellness
  - Improve and Create New Places for Play and Recreation in the Community
  - Enhance the Healthy Food Environment
- Improve Resident Safety
  - Target Nuisance Corner Stores for Loitering and Crime
  - Reduce Crime through Community-Based Activities, Environmental Design, and Partnerships
- Improve Sanitation
  - Keep the Neighborhood Clean
- Create Connections and Access
  - Improve Traffic Conditions, Pedestrian Safety, and Walkability
  - Make Transportation Enhancements



# INVEST IN HOUSING AND NEIGHBORHOOD MARKET- STRENGTHENING DEVELOPMENT OPPORTUNITIES

*Build confidence in the neighborhood while improving the housing market.*



## *Identify and Support Strategic Redevelopment Opportunities*



### **1. Support the reuse of Rognel Heights Elementary/Middle School**

Rognel Heights Elementary/Middle School is slated to close in 2018. Afterwards, the site will undergo a process to “surplus” the building so that it can be reused in a productive way. The City will conduct community stakeholder engagement and analysis, including explaining the surplus school disposition process, sharing profiles of potential re-uses, engaging stakeholders about desired uses, explain market assessment, and engage stakeholders about concerns for the site. Discussions about desired uses could include short-term and long-term uses, indoor and outdoor uses, shared use opportunities, demolition and open space opportunities, as well as demolition and new construction opportunities.

### **2. Re-invigorate the Healthy Neighborhoods program to incentivize home improvements, market the area, and spur investment in the community.**

The Edmondson Village, Lyndhurst and Edgewood communities make up the designated Healthy Neighborhoods area, and are able to benefit from the program. The Healthy Neighborhoods liaison is currently located in Go-Northwest’s neighborhood office in northwest Baltimore. In order to have higher visibility and impact, especially as excitement builds

due to the Lyndhurst construction, residents should partner with the Healthy Neighborhoods liaison to have set “office hours” each week in a centrally-located satellite office in Edmondson Village. Community leaders should also work with elected officials to advocate the expansion of the Healthy Neighborhoods boundary to include the Allendale Community. Both Healthy Neighborhoods and Live Baltimore should use the modernized school as an opportunity to market the community.



### **3. Consider landmark designation for eligible properties.**

There are many historical assets in the neighborhood. In addition to the area becoming a National Historic district, many historically significant buildings in Edmondson Village are eligible to become Baltimore City historic landmarks – a designation administered by the Commission for Historical and Architectural Preservation (CHAP). Landmark designation would help ensure that the historic character of the potential landmarks and the neighborhood are preserved by reviewing changes to the exterior of the structure. If landmarked these properties would be protected from demolition, and would be eligible for local, state, and federal historic preservation tax credits for rehabilitation. Economic studies on historic preservation show that well restored and maintained historic landmarks can be anchors of community well-being and catalysts for neighborhood revitalization. CHAP can assist owners of eligible properties by



discussing the specific implications of landmark designation. The following properties are eligible for local landmark designation:

- Edmondson Village Shopping Center (4508-4590 Edmondson Avenue)
- St. Bernardine Roman Catholic Church (3812 Edmondson Avenue)
- New Covenant United Methodist Church (700 Wildwood Parkway)
- Connexion Point Church (3816 Edmondson Avenue)
- Manifest Wonders Christian Center (3600 Edmondson Avenue)
- Olivet Baptist Church (Old Movie Theater - 3500 Edmondson Avenue)
- Vaugh S. Green Funeral Home (4101 Edmondson Avenue)
- Enoch Pratt Free Library (4330 Edmondson Avenue)

## *Create and Maintain High-Quality, Affordable Housing for Rent and Sale*

### **4. Rehabilitate and occupy vacant properties in areas that are highly visible, most stable, and/or immediately adjacent to the school within the first few years of the school building reopening.**

In order to build on the attractiveness and marketability of Edmondson Village, it is important to prioritize the rehabilitation of vacant property where it gains from stronger blocks and/or assets in

the community. Much of the area has been designated by HCD as a Vacants to Value Streamlined Code Enforcement Cluster, where administrative citations and receivership can help move properties to rehabilitation and occupancy. This activity may help spur further investment as well. These are immediate opportunities for rehabilitation:

- 3408 Edmondson Avenue: Available through One House at a Time
- 3412 Edmondson Avenue and 422 Loudon Avenue: City-owned/available through Vacants to Value:
- 3432 and 3908 Edmondson Avenue, 526 and 527 Loudon Avenue, and 620 Denison Street: Undergoing receivership
- 3905 Edmondson Avenue: Soon to undergo receivership



### **5. Facilitate rehabilitation of vacant houses**

Many residents have identified an opportunity to address multiple issues in the neighborhood by rehabbing vacant properties. They envision being able to reduce vacancies, create development job opportunities, and prepare residents for homeownership. Resident leaders are in the initial stages of considering how best to accomplish their goals, which might include starting a new CDC or partnering with existing entities and developers. Interested individuals should work with the Healthy Neighborhoods liaison to explore options for facilitating a greater volume of rehab projects in the neighborhood.



**6. Promote homeowner assistance programs to help current or new owners improve their homes.**

Home investments and improvements raise confidence in the area and contribute to its stability. To help low-income or elderly homeowners maintain their properties and keep energy bills low, neighborhood organizations and the new Community School Coordinator should work with the City and nonprofits to promote assistance programs at community association meetings, and events. These programs include those operated by Baltimore Housing's Green, Healthy and Sustainable Homes Division, including:

- The Baltimore Energy Challenge to educate homeowners about lowering energy bills
- The Leading Innovation for a Green and Healthy Tomorrow (LIGHT) Program, which provides comprehensive benefits screenings and case management to coordinate housing, energy conservation, health, safety, and financial services



**7. Work with agencies and organizations to develop and implement a toolkit to incentivize landlords to maintain and improve rental units in the neighborhood.**

With 48% of households living in rental housing, it is important to incentivize good management of affordable, high-quality rental properties. Community leaders and residents continue to point out a significant number of irresponsible landlords in the community who do not maintain their property and/or rent to people who are just as negligent. This often results in properties that reduce the attractiveness and marketability of the neighborhood. Programs to offer

financial or other benefits to encourage responsible landlord behavior should be created.

## *Support and Increase Homeownership*

**8. Identify organizations in the neighborhood or city that can assist renters ready to become homeowners.**

As investments take place around the modernized school, this may be a good time for stable renters interested in becoming homeowners to prepare for homeownership. Many organizations can provide individuals and families with homeownership counseling and real estate professional services, and connect them with buying incentive programs to help make the dream of affordable homeownership a reality. Community organizations, churches, the school, and other trusted entities should promote organizations that can help, such as GO Northwest Healthy Neighborhoods Inc., Live Baltimore, St. Ambrose Housing Aid Center and Baltimore Housing's Office of Homeownership.

## *Remove Blight*

**9. Partner with the Community Law Center to develop a strategy to remediate nuisance properties and activities.**

The Community Law Center (CLC) is dedicated to strengthening neighborhoods by offering legal advice and assistance to community associations and non-profit organizations. CLC assistance can help move blighted properties to revitalization and reduce crime and nuisance activities in residential and commercial properties. The Lyndhurst community organization should complete the application for CLC assistance in the community to identify and target nuisance properties. The community should also work with HCD to identify the most effective pathways to remediate nuisance properties.

**10. Demolish blighted alley garages near the school, where the properties are significantly impacting residents.**

One of the largest areas of blighted properties within the quarter-mile radius of Lyndhurst is a series of alley garages, bounded by the 3700-block of Edmondson Avenue, 600-block of Mount Holly Street, 600-block of Allendale Street, and the 3700-block of Harlem Avenue. Approximately 25 concrete garages have been an eyesore for a number of years; they are missing doors, roofs, and exterior walls, and have high weeds, grass, and trees growing out of them. These garages are unsafe for residents and children who may want to play in their backyards. HCD has initiated efforts with the Maryland Stadium Authority to demolish the inner rows of these garages through Project C.O.R.E. *See Appendix C for information about Project C.O.R.E.*



***Improve Retail Businesses and Seek Quality Entrepreneurs in the Community***

**11. Baltimore Development Corporation should work with business owners to improve local retail establishments and the business environment.**

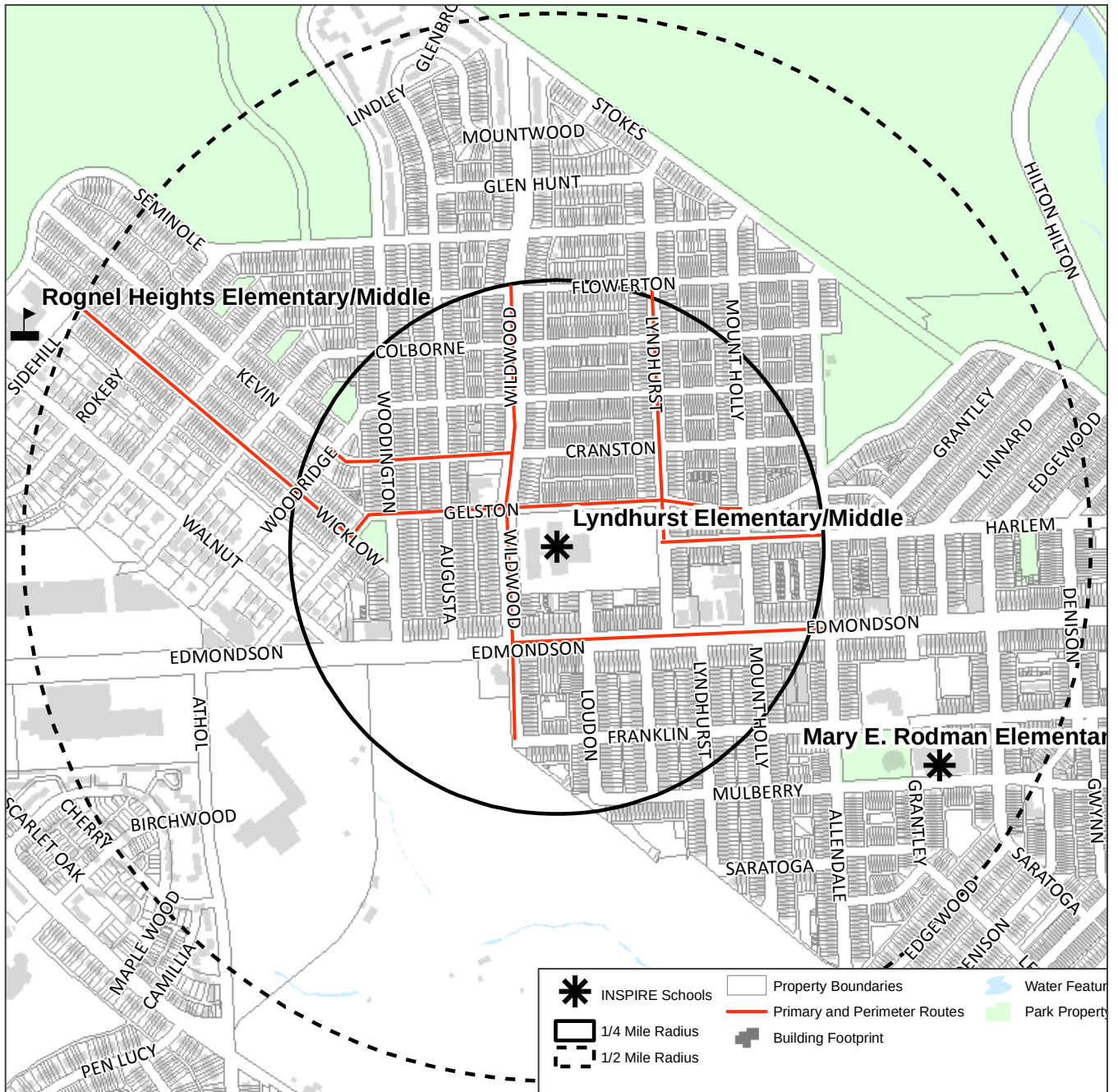
Nuisance and unkept businesses near residences and the school detract from the quality-of-life in the neighborhood. BDC, the Department of Planning, and community leaders should explore opportunities to work with local business entities to provide business assistance for these establishments. Examples of BDC





# CREATE ENVIRONMENTALLY SUSTAINABLE NEIGHBORHOODS

*Build on the significant natural assets in the community and create stronger connections through land reuse.*



## *Beautify Highly-visible Public Spaces*

### **13. Create decorative landscape treatments along the edge of Gwynns Falls Leakin Park.**

Landscaping the edge of Gwynns Falls Leakin Park would “formalize” the relationship of the park to Edmondson Village and the adjacent Hunting Ridge community. One treatment, installing decorative boulders at key locations along the park’s edge from Stokes Drive to Seminole Avenue, would create a consistent aesthetic appearance throughout the Edmondson Village community and the adjacent Hunting Ridge community’s park edge. This recommendation was also noted in the 2007 Edmondson Village Area Master Plan. Community organizations should work with agencies and others such as the Neighborhood Design Center, Parks and People, Civic Works, or a landscape architect to assist in making these improvements. The following treatments should be considered by BCRP:

- Work with the community and Healthy Neighborhoods to coordinate installation of boulders along park edges from Stokes Drive to Seminole Avenue
- Install decorative wooden bollards at select locations along the park edges



### **14. Install new guardrails along Gelston Drive from Denison to Edgewood Street.**

The guard rails along the park’s edge in the Edgewood community are decades old, no longer functional, and need to be replaced. In some areas broken wooden bollards are the only things separating vehicles from dangerous drops along the park’s edge. Baltimore City Department of Transportation should assess these conditions and repair or replace the old bollards and/or install new guardrails.



## *Contribute to the Green Network through Lot Restoration*

### **15. Develop green reuse treatments for lots where appropriate.**

With a number of vacant lots in the area, it is important for community stakeholders, agencies, and others to work together to create productive green places. This could include seeding and fencing properties, planting trees, clearing overgrowth, installing temporary art, land maintenance, and/or community managed open space. The locations below should be assessed for treatment options with the Growing Green Initiative:

- Alley lots at Loudon and W. Mulberry, Lyndhurst and W. Mulberry, and alley parcel behind 4000 Franklin Street for beautification

## Community-based Priority Projects



Stakeholders involved in the INSPIRE planning process identified a few of the recommendations as priorities that they would like to see funded through the INSPIRE GO bonds. DOP will work with residents over the next few months to determine what to move ahead with. DOP is assessing what it would take to implement the following projects:

- Beautifying the .375-acre vacant lot at 700 Denison Street which has been vacant for over ten years. The Morgan State University School of Architecture + Planning will be

including this site as a design project for their 2017 Fall curriculum. The community will provide guidance about what is meaningful to them and feedback on the designs. One concept is to mimic the recent improvements made across the street at the former Harlem Park playground lot, which has been newly decorated with trees, landscaping, decorative boulders and green space.

- Beautifying the lot in the 600-block of N. Woodington Road to honor military veterans. Adding features to the site, which currently holds an American flag, such as a garden and decorative boulders would create a place to pay tribute.
- Providing façade improvement grants to help local businesses create a positive visual impact on the street. BDC could work with business owners on design assistance and investments such as upgraded signage, painting, landscaping, and more.

- City-owned vacant lot next to 748 Denison Street, Block 2501 Lot 100A (possible fence)
- City-owned vacant lot at 700 Denison Street (see project description above)
- City-owned lots at 501-503 Normandy (potentially a site for a privately-funded playground)
- Vacant lot behind the Edmondson Village Shopping Center (potentially temporary greenspace, as long-term options are explored)

### **16. Beautify the triangular lot in the 600-block of N. Woodington Road with decorative treatments to honor military veterans.**

Residents in the Edmondson Village community would like to beautify this vacant parcel and create a space to honor and pay tribute to veterans. Members of the community have maintained this lot for years; they would like to add a butterfly garden, a

flower bed, and decorative boulders surrounding the flag pole. The community should work with the Healthy Neighborhoods liaison to help make these improvements.

### **17. Increase the tree canopy in the community.**

Although Gwynns Falls Leakin Park provides significant green space and trees in the neighborhood, the INSPIRE area could benefit from additional street trees. Trees contribute to a more pedestrian-friendly experience by providing shade, and color, and reducing noise pollution. Residents pointed to a few locations for strategically placed street trees to enhance the aesthetic appeal of the Edmondson corridor. Tree Baltimore should consider plantings at these locations:

- 4001 and 3939 Edmondson Avenue and Loudon Avenue (one at each corner)
- Allendale and Edmondson Avenue (northwest corner)





### **18. Expand Lyndhurst’s efforts to become a green and sustainable school.**

Significant opportunities exist for Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School to adopt sustainability education and best practices in order to reach regionally- or nationally- recognized “Green School” designations (e.g. Maryland Association for Environmental and Outdoor Education Green School and Sustainable School; US Department of Education Green Ribbon). Lyndhurst has indicated interest in sustainability and obtained the Green, Healthy, Smart Challenge grant in SY 2015-16 to help start recycling initiatives and gardening.

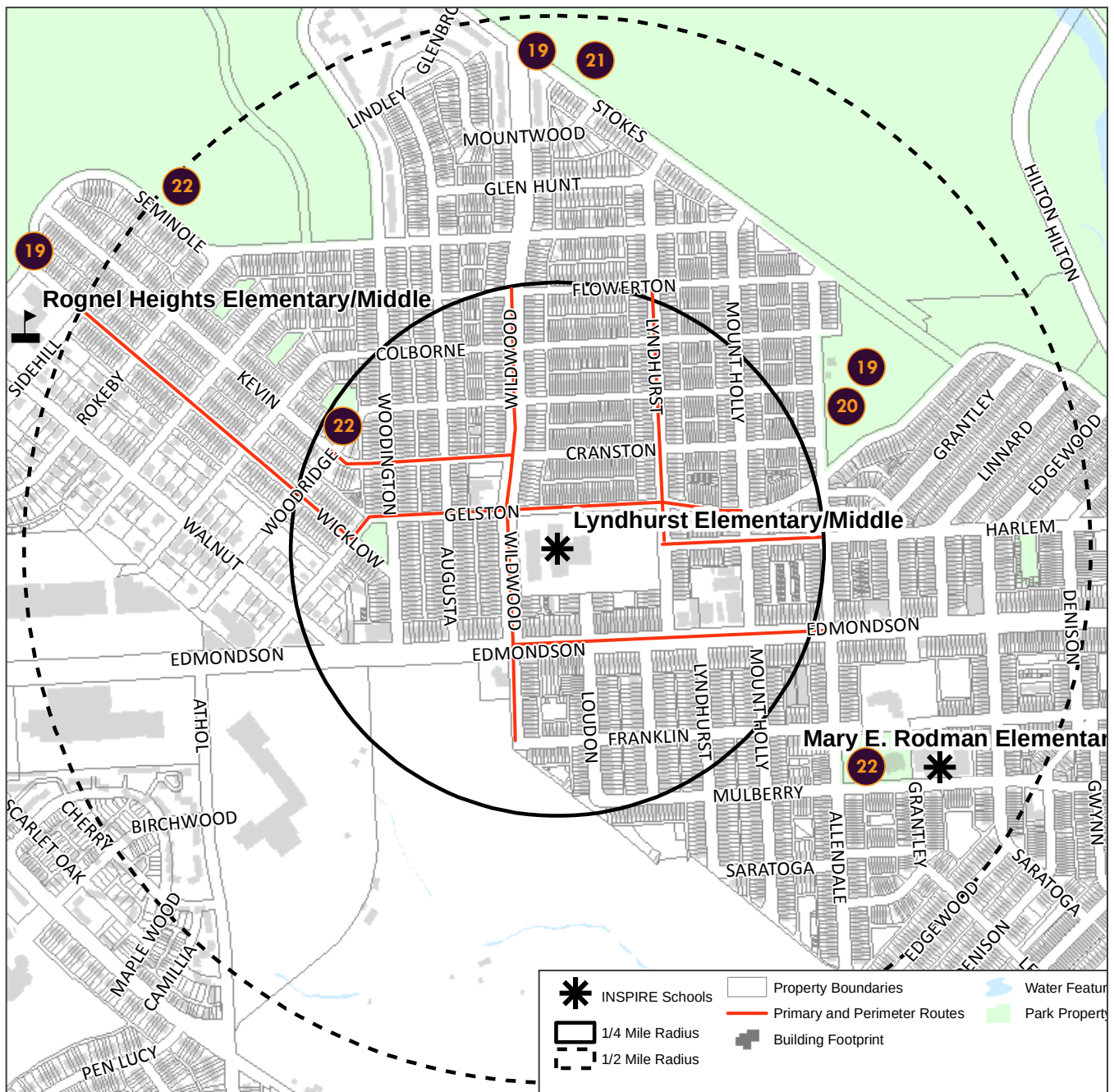
Recommendations for creating long-term engagement in sustainability education include:

- Forming and maintaining a green team comprised of students, teachers, and other staff;
- Integrating environmental education into the classroom and throughout the school, including schoolyard greening, gardening, and learning;
- Conserving energy, water, and other natural resources; and
- Reusing materials whenever possible, and meeting the state law requiring every school to recycle (including paper, cardboard, glass, metal, plastic, electronics, toner cartridges, and light bulbs).

Additionally, Lyndhurst can use the rich natural resources present in the Gwynns Falls Park to engage students in local meaningful watershed educational experiences. While taking part in the Family League’s community engagement process, residents and stakeholders noted in the Community School Action Plan that Lyndhurst should develop a “Going Green” Initiative wherein students should participate in activities to reduce environmental waste. These efforts combined, should help Lyndhurst achieve this goal.

# CREATE OPPORTUNITIES FOR HEALTH AND WELLNESS

*Improve and create new places for residents to safely play, recreate, and come together.*





## *Improve and Create New Places for Play and Recreation in the Community*

### **19. Increase recreational programming for youth and area residents.**

Many residents would like to create more youth programs and a uniformed sports league with activities such as baseball, softball, basketball, or soccer in order to provide positive outlets for youth. To help achieve this, it will be important for community residents to work with the Department of Recreation and Parks and recreation center staff to organize such teams or leagues. Active young adults would be ideal to oversee these activities. Increased programming will also provide adults with more opportunities to be active and healthy.



### **20. Make improvements at the Edgewood Lyndhurst Recreation Center**

The Edgewood Lyndhurst Recreation Center, built in 2005, provides recreation services for the neighborhood. Since its construction, Recreation and Parks has continued to invest in this site. Recent upgrades include adding a gym, which was completed in 2012. In FY2018, BCRP is planning to make court renovation improvements to the existing tennis courts. The community has requested additional parking to accommodate the number of people who use the recreation center during large events, but there isn't space available to provide additional parking. The community would also like to see increased lighting to

illuminate the athletic field for safety during night-time football practice, but BCRP is not able to provide additional lighting.



### **21. Recondition the baseball fields along edge of Gwynns Fall Leakin Park.**

There are two baseball fields along the edge of Gwynns Falls Leakin Park that are underutilized and in poor condition. Residents would like to create an organized baseball or softball league, but would need the fields to be improved in order to run the leagues. The grass-top baseball field located at 4100 Stokes Dr. and Glenbrook Road could be converted into a regulation field, including a baseball diamond, lighting, benches, and more. In addition, the baseball field located at 4200 Seminole Avenue at Kevin Road could be refurbished. Residents should work with the Department of Recreation and Parks to pursue these desired improvements. At the same time, residents should initiate more community involvement in recreational programming to take full advantage of these park assets.

### **22. Restore existing neighborhood playgrounds and courts.**

Certain playgrounds and basketball courts in the neighborhood have become, or are becoming, run down and need to be refurbished. BCRP has programmed future improvements for the following areas:

- The basketball court at Woodridge and Woodington Rd. (Kevin and Woodridge Park)
- The playground lot surface at 4200 Seminole Avenue

The basketball court behind Mary Rodman Elementary School may be addressed through the 21st Century school renovation plans, along with a new playground to be built by school year 2020.



## *Enhance the Healthy Food Environment*

### **23. Develop and implement a comprehensive food access strategy.**

There is better access to healthy and affordable food in some parts of the INSPIRE area than others. The blocks closest to Lyndhurst are in a food desert. With a Giant supermarket less than one mile away, and other food and nutrition programming available, community and school leaders should develop an overall food and nutrition strategy. This could include:

- Providing transportation to the Giant. In summer 2016, members of Edmondson Village and surrounding neighborhoods worked with the Baltimore Development Corporation and the No Boundaries Coalition to survey 236 residents about transportation challenges trav-

eling to or from the Giant. The conversation is still ongoing and may result in the creation of a shuttle or other ride service to and/or from Giant.

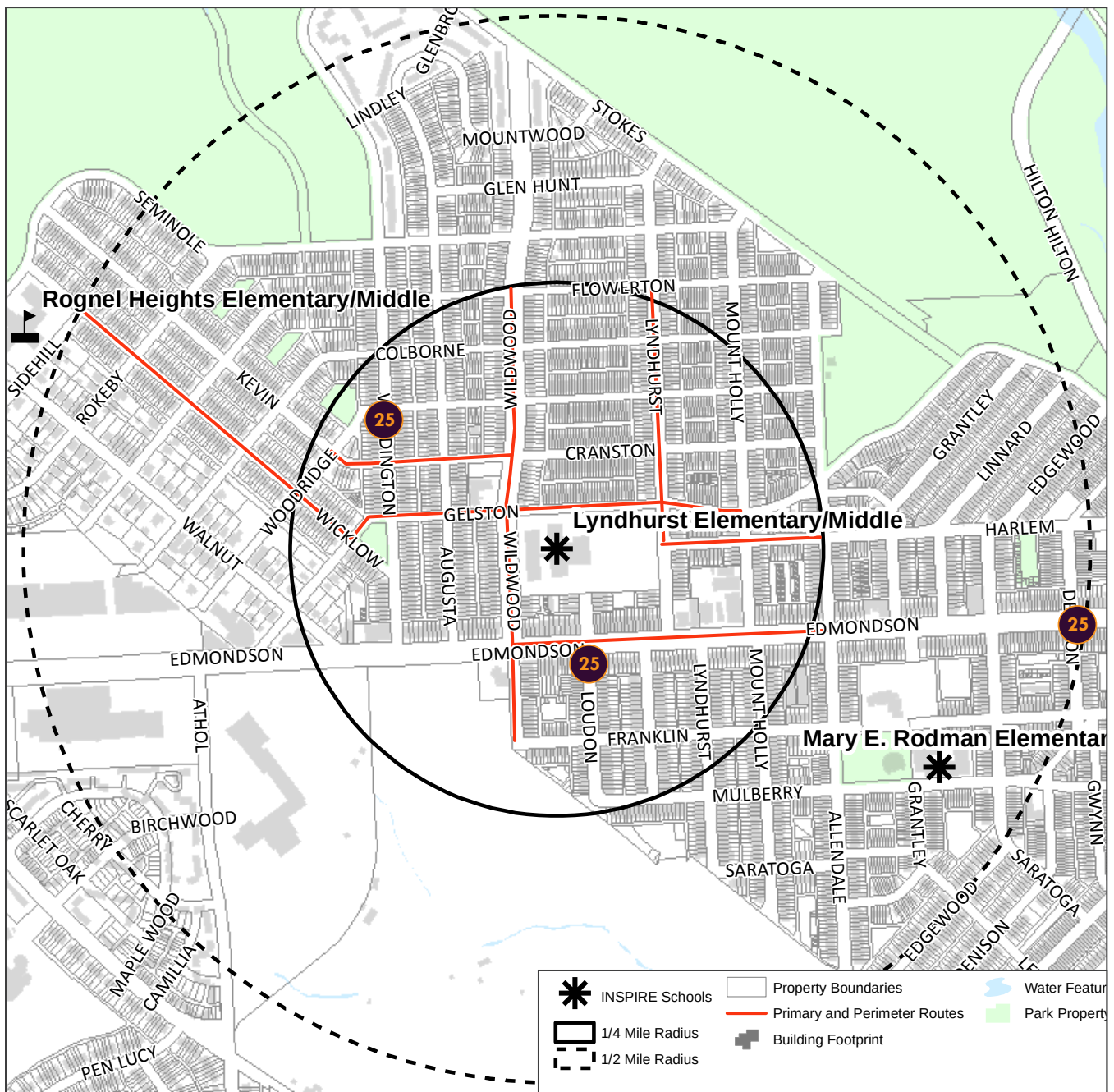
- Exploring opportunities for school families to receive nutrition education in the Giant through the Food Supplement Nutrition Education Program's Cooking Matters in the Store, or similar initiatives. The Community School Coordinator at Lyndhurst should explore this opportunity, and also coordinate with the Fresh Fruit and Vegetable Program through Food and Nutrition Services to provide children with repeated opportunities to try and taste fruits and vegetables that are featured in nutrition education or in store activities.
- Promoting the Edmondson Village Farmers Market. During the summer months, the Farmers Market in Edmondson Village is located at the West Side Skill Center (4501 Edmondson Avenue) and accepts and doubles federal nutrition benefits to assist low-income families in purchasing healthy food. The market should promote to the school community, such as at open house nights or with flyers so that families are aware of the additional programming and incentives.

### **24. Encourage healthy food retail, especially at corner stores near the school.**

There are several corner stores in the neighborhood that children may pass on their way to and from school to purchase snacks or meals. These stores have a low availability of healthy food. Residents and store owners should partner with the Health Department to explore opportunities for these stores to become part of the Baltimarket Healthy Corner Store Program, which assists stores in stocking and marketing healthy food, as well as informing stores about changes to federal nutrition programs, such as SNAP (food stamps).

## IMPROVE RESIDENT SAFETY

*Create a positive and safe environment, and address real and perceived safety concerns.*





## *Target Nuisance Corner Stores for Loitering and Crime*

### **25. Reduce nuisances caused by corner stores.**

Several of the corner stores near Lyndhurst sell alcohol and attract nuisance behavior such as loitering, littering, and crime. As part of Transform Baltimore – the new zoning code that goes into effect on June 5, 2017 – stores selling liquor in residentially-zoned areas (as these are) must stop selling liquor by June 5, 2019. This presents an opportunity for these establishments to become safer, healthier, and more inviting. In the interim, residents should seek assistance from the Community Law Center to address loitering, crime, and littering issues through nuisance abatement laws. The following properties have generated the most concern:

- 3401 Edmondson Avenue
- 3730 Edmondson Avenue
- 3939 Edmondson Avenue
- 4001 Edmondson Avenue
- 801 Woodington Road

## *Reduce Crime through Community-based Activities, Environmental Design, and Partnerships*

### **26. Partner with the Southwest Police District to increase community policing and neighborhood visibility.**

There are a few places in the community known to be havens for crime, drug activity, and loitering. The police and community should work together to develop and activate a proactive strategy to address these areas and make residents feel safer. This might include:

- Initiating an “Engaged Presence Produces Reduction” (EPPR) strategy by increasing patrols of these areas through community-organized “good neighbor walks,” prayer walks



with local clergy, exercise walks to identify neighborhood issues, and motorized canvases of the community. This could also include Citizens on Patrol (COP), where citizens will walk the community with a police officer to deter crime and note problem areas for crime, loitering, and illegal activity.

- Community organizations working with the Guardian Angels, a uniformed crime prevention organization, to patrol the neighborhoods.
- Police educating residents about being safe in their neighborhood.

### **27. Use crime prevention design principles to enhance safety.**

The fact that most of the houses in the neighborhood surrounding Lyndhurst are occupied works in favor of implementing design principle and community projects to enhance safety in the area. Two ways this can be accomplished are by launching a “lighting campaign” to increase the light level on residential blocks and incorporating Crime Prevention through Environmental Design (CPTED) principles.

- CPTED is defined as a multi-disciplinary approach to deterring criminal behavior that focuses on changing how places are laid out, and how they look and feel. Strategies rely on the ability to influence offender decisions that precede criminal acts by affecting the built and social environment. It focuses on altering

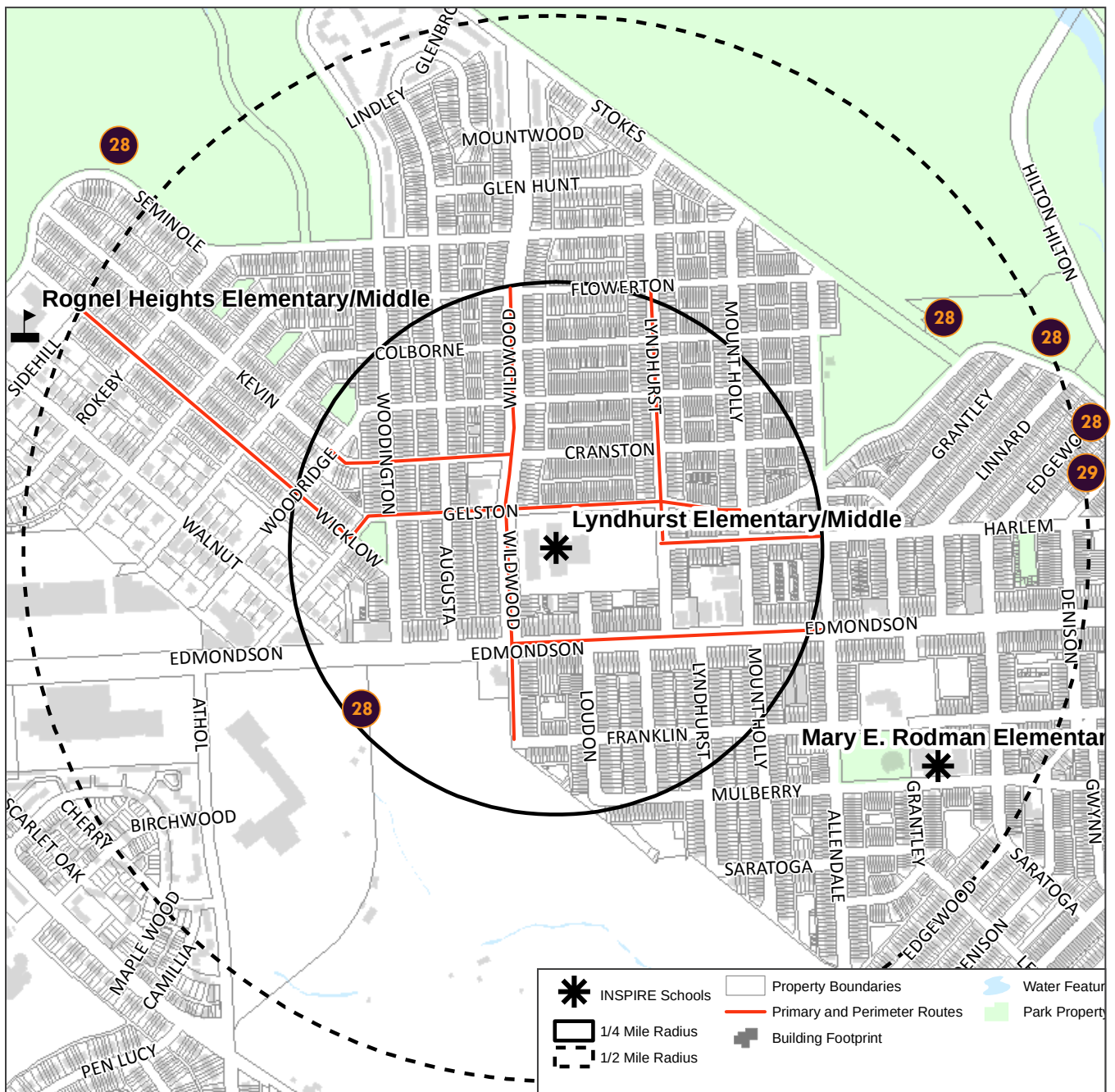


the physical design of spaces that attract or allow criminal activity to flourish. Improving the visual appearances of streets with new street trees or trimming overgrown trees and shrubs, strategically placing lighting, demolishing blighted properties, and fostering more “eyes on the street” are some of the CPTED elements that should be implemented. Basic principles include “natural surveillance,” and “territoriality,” which also looks at how community signage and maintenance suggest that a space is cared for. Community members can work with the police as well as property developers to advocate for CPTED principles in their work.

- A number of residents have noted that even with the City’s new LED lighting, streets and sidewalks are not illuminated enough. Residents should consider working with Healthy Neighborhoods, Inc. to launch a campaign to encourage using porch or lawn lighting to brighten streets and sidewalks. Additionally, DOP can work with the community and the Baltimore Office of Promotion and the Arts to explore tree lighting along areas including Wildwood Parkway.

# IMPROVE SANITATION

*Protect residents and the environment by keeping the neighborhood clean.*



## *Keep the Neighborhood Clean*

### **28. Increase and target code enforcement efforts in areas known for trash, illegal dumping, and rodents.**

While the neighborhoods around Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School are generally well maintained, they contain several locations that are re-occurring sites for illegal dumping and trash. The Department of Public Works and the Housing Department's Code Enforcement Officers should establish Code Enforcement Zones (CEZ's) that will target these areas. The following sites should be targeted for increased sanitation enforcement – including citations, cleaning, and possible camera locations – by the Department of Public Works and Housing's Code Enforcement staff:

- Alley behind the 700-block of Denison Street: Cut down overgrowth and weeds (even side)
- Rear of Edmondson Village Shopping Center
- Areas along the edge of Gwynns Falls Leakin Park at Gelston and Edgewood, Gelston and Stokes Drive, and Seminole Avenue and Rokeby Road
- Eastern edge of Edmondson High school near the cemetery (along the fence)

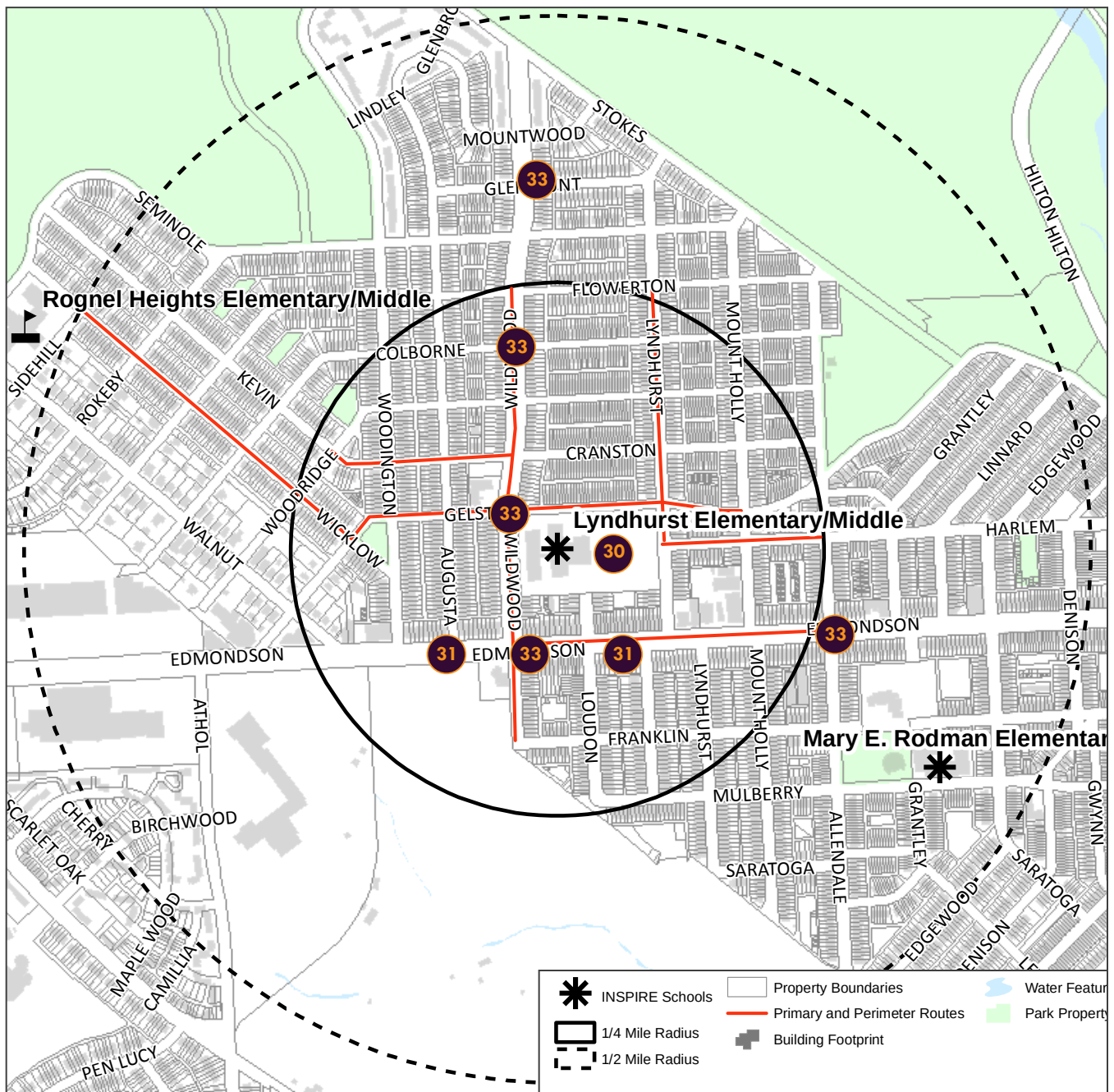
### **29. Install bollards at the back end of alley intersection of Denison Street and N. Hilton Street to prevent chronic dumping.**

The alley intersection behind the 700-block of Denison Street and N. Hilton Street, adjacent to a City-owned lot (Block 2501 Lot 100A), is a site of chronic dumping, and is overgrown with weeds and grass. The Edgewood community president and residents have addressed the grass and weeds but are unable to prevent the dumping that has degraded the appearance of the block for years. It is recommended that the Department of Transportation install metal bollards at the back of the alley corner to prevent the re-occurring problem of dumping.



# CREATE CONNECTIONS AND ACCESS

*Connect residents safely and efficiently to the places  
they need and want to go.*





## *Improve Traffic Conditions, Pedestrian Safety, and Walkability*

### **30. Create a “walking school bus,” “bicycle train,” or “block captain” program.**

With most students likely not qualifying for school bus pickup, measures should be developed to ensure safety for children during the travel to and from school. Explore models and opportunities for walking school buses (a group of children walking with one or more adults), bicycle trains (a group of children biking with adults), and block captain programs. School staff as well as parents and community leaders should work together to institute this program if desired. See *Appendix C for more information.*



### **31. Make Edmondson Avenue safer for pedestrians.**

Walking along Edmondson Avenue can feel very unsafe. Sidewalks are narrow and traffic is fast. Speed limits in school zones throughout the region and nationwide are typically at 25 MPH; Edmondson Avenue is a high-traffic corridor and is zoned for 30 MPH. As Lyndhurst doubles its capacity, more students will be walking and additional traffic will come through the area. DOT should assess traffic and safety, and consider appropriate traffic calming measures that might include the following:

- Reducing the speed limit on Edmondson Avenue near the school to 25 MPH

- Temporarily installing illuminated LED Travel Speed Indicators on Edmondson Avenue, east and west of the school, at the beginning of the school year
- Painting yellow street line markings beside the curbs in the street on Edmondson Avenue near the school
- Installing new pedestrian crosswalks on both sides of Loudon Avenue and Lyndhurst Street.
- Installing decorative pedestrian safety bollards in the 4000-block of Edmondson Avenue at the intersection of Wildwood Parkway



## *Make Transportation Enhancements*

### **32. Explore ways to accommodate safe bicycle travel to school and in the neighborhood.**

Students who may want to bike to school should have a safe, easy way to do so. In addition to assessing opportunities along the school perimeter and primary walking routes, residents, students, and school staff should look at the Baltimore City Bike Master Plan to identify other possible methods to make biking safer around the school and in the community. Secure bicycle racks at the school and near community facilities will make it more likely people will bike as well.

### **33. Provide additional transportation enhancements around Lyndhurst.**

The Edmondson Avenue corridor is the primary means of entry into and out of the communities that surround Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School. DOT enhancements along this corridor and highly-traveled streets such as Wildwood Parkway will make these highly-trafficked areas more aesthetically pleasing and create a visible entry point for the 21st Century school. The following are specific enhancements:

- Provide a new bus stop bench and/or a shelter at Allendale and Edmondson Avenue, and new benches at Edmondson and Wildwood Parkway, and Edmondson and Hilton Street
  - Plant ornamental trees and shrubs along the Edmondson Avenue median
- 
- Landscape the Wildwood Parkway median including tree trimming, planters, and flowers
  - Continue community efforts to beautify the Edmondson Avenue corridor, including decorative banners

# Plan Implementation

**INSPIRE plans are already beginning to be implemented. Although not everything can happen right away, the Department of Planning is committed to continuing to work with community members to see recommendations become reality.**

**The Department of Planning, community stakeholders, and others should continuously refer to this section to hold each other accountable. This section:**

- **Sets forth a desired time frame for implementation**
- **Identifies lead and support agencies/organizations**
- **Estimates the cost of implementation and identified or potential funding sources**
- **Identifies commitments already made**

**As part of completing the plan, City agencies have already made some funding and staffing commitments. Complete implementation however, will require more resources.**

**We believe that the significant investment in Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School, in addition to the commitments represented in these tables, can encourage additional resources.**

## **Timeframe**

Short: 0-2 years

Medium: 3-5 years

Long: 5+ years

## **Estimated Cost of Improvements**

\$ = \$5,000 or less

\$\$ = \$5,001-\$50,000

\$\$\$ = \$50,001-\$250,000

\$\$\$\$ = \$250,001 - \$500,000

\$\$\$\$\$ = More than \$500,000

## **Lead Responsibility (for funding, advocacy, implementation)**

### ***Baltimore City Agencies***

BCPD: Baltimore City Police Department

BDC: Baltimore Development Corporation

DGS: Department of General Services

HCD: Dept. of Housing and Community  
Development

DOP: Department of Planning

DPW: Department of Public Works

BCRP: Department of Recreation and Parks

DOT: Department of Transportation

### ***Other***

Private: Philanthropy, anchor institutions,  
investors, etc.

Community: Residents, Community-Based  
Organizations (CBOs) or community groups,  
businesses, etc.

HNI: Healthy Neighborhoods, Inc.

## Implementing Standard Improvements

**Agencies have committed to making these improvements in time  
for the re-opening of the school buildings.**

| Recommendations & Actions                                                                                                                                            | Timeframe                                 | Lead Responsibility | Estimated Cost | Funding                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------|------------------------|
| Repair sidewalk deficiencies                                                                                                                                         | By fall 2017                              | DOT                 | \$\$\$         | INSPIRE GO Bonds       |
| Assess need to repair ADA ramps at intersections                                                                                                                     | By January 2018                           | DOT                 | TBD            | DOT                    |
| Dig tree pits                                                                                                                                                        | By fall/winter 2017                       | DOT                 | TBD            | INSPIRE GO Bonds       |
| Repaint or add crosswalks: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>In addition to all crosswalks around schools, assess Gelston and Lyndhurst intersection</li> </ul> | By January 2018                           | DOT                 | TBD            | DOT                    |
| Assess crossing guard allocation                                                                                                                                     | Before Jan. 2018 and in first weeks       | DOT                 | N/A            | N/A                    |
| Asses speed near school and along primary routes/<br>Assess Edmondson Ave. for LED speed indicators near school                                                      | By January 2018                           | DOT                 | N/A            | N/A                    |
| Install school signage/Replace or repair as needed <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Need new signage along Edmondson Ave.</li> </ul>                           | By January 2018                           | DOT                 |                | DOT                    |
| Post speed signs and speed sentry                                                                                                                                    | 1-2 weeks before and after school opening | DOT                 | N/A            | N/A                    |
| Replace street light bulbs with LED bulbs                                                                                                                            | TBD                                       | DOT                 | TBD            | DOT                    |
| Conduct Safe Routes to School Training                                                                                                                               | Before January 2018 or in first weeks     | DOT                 | N/A            | N/A                    |
| Remove and replace dead street trees                                                                                                                                 | Fall 2017                                 | BCRP                | \$-\$\$        | BCRP                   |
| Plant new street trees                                                                                                                                               | Fall 2017                                 | BCRP                | \$\$\$         | BCRP, INSPIRE GO Bonds |
| Proactive pruning                                                                                                                                                    | Ongoing                                   | BCRP                | \$\$           | BCRP                   |
| Board vacant and accessible properties                                                                                                                               | By January 2018; Ongoing                  | HCD, DPW            | \$             | HCD, DPW               |
| Clean and mow vacant lots                                                                                                                                            | By January 2018; Ongoing                  | DPW                 | \$             | HCD, DPW               |
| Conduct a Clean Sweep along entire primary walking routes                                                                                                            | By January 2018                           | DPW                 | S              | DPW                    |
| Conduct regular code enforcement sweeps along the primary walking routes                                                                                             | Ongoing                                   | N/A                 | N/A            | HCD                    |



## Implementing Lyndhurst Area Recommendations

Capital projects with at least some funding or commitments are italicized.

### *Investing in Housing and Neighborhood Market-Strengthening Development Opportunities*

| Recommendation & Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Timeframe    | Lead Responsibility                          | Estimated Cost | Potential Funding |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| <b>Identify and Support Redevelopment Opportunities</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |              |                                              |                |                   |
| 1. Support the reuse of Rognel Heights Elementary/Middle School.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Short        | <b>City Space Utilization Committee, HCD</b> | N/A            | N/A               |
| 2. Re-invigorate the Healthy Neighborhoods program to incentivize home improvements, market the area, and spur investment in the community.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Short        | <b>Go-Northwest/HNI</b>                      | N/A            | Grants            |
| 3. Consider landmark designation for eligible properties. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Edmondson Village Shopping Center</li> <li>St. Bernardine Roman Catholic Church</li> <li>New Covenant Worship Center</li> <li>Connexion Point Church</li> <li>Manifest Wonders Christian Church</li> <li>Olivet Baptist Church (Old Movie Theater)</li> <li>Vaugh S. Green Funeral Home</li> <li>Enoch Pratt Free Library</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Short-Medium | <b>Private (property owners), CHAP/DOP</b>   | N/A            | N/A               |
| <b>Create and Maintain High-Quality, Affordable Housing for Rent and Sale</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |              |                                              |                |                   |
| 4. Rehabilitate and occupy vacant properties in areas that are highly visible, most stable, and/or immediately adjacent to the school within the first few years of the school buildings re-opening <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Available through One House At A Time: 3408 Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>City-owned/available through V2V: 3412 Edmondson Ave., 422 Loudon Ave.</li> <li>Undergoing receivership: 3432 and 3908 Edmondson Ave., 526 and 527 Loudon Ave., 620 Denison St.</li> <li>Will undergo receivership: 3905 Edmondson</li> </ul>                                                                                                         | Short-Medium | <b>Private, HCD</b>                          | N/A            | Private           |
| 5. Facilitate rehabilitation of vacant houses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Short-Medium | <b>Community, Private</b>                    | TBD            | TBD               |
| 6. Promote homeowner assistance programs to help current or new owners improve their homes. Connect homeowners with programs available through Baltimore Housing's Green, Healthy, and Sustainable Homes division by sharing program information at community association meetings, community events, and through the school. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Promote the Baltimore Energy Challenge to educate homeowners about lowering energy bills</li> <li>Promote the LIGHT Program, which provides comprehensive benefits screenings and case management to coordinate housing, energy conservation, health, safety, and financial services</li> </ul> | Ongoing      | <b>NHI, School, HCD</b>                      | N/A            | N/A               |
| 7. Work with agencies and organizations to develop and implement a toolkit to incentivize good landlords to maintain rental units in the neighborhood.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Short        | <b>HCD, DOP, Advocacy Organizations</b>      | N/A            | N/A               |
| <b>Support and Increase Homeownership</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |              |                                              |                |                   |
| 8. Identify organizations in the neighborhood or city that can assist renters ready to become homeowners.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Ongoing      | <b>Community/CBO, HCD, Private</b>           | N/A            | N/A               |

| Recommendation & Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Timeframe    | Lead Responsibility                      | Estimated Cost | Potential Funding                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>Remove Blight</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |              |                                          |                |                                          |
| 9. Partner with the Community Law Center (CLC) to develop a strategy to remediate nuisance properties and activities.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Short        | Community, CLC, DOP                      | N/A            | N/A                                      |
| 10. Demolish blighted alley garages near the school, where the properties are significantly impacting residents. This table lists only properties that are already funded for demolition:<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Inner-block of alley garages in block 2847</li> </ul>                                                                                                          | Short        | HCD                                      | \$\$           | Project CORE                             |
| <b>Improve Retail Businesses and Seek Quality Entrepreneurs in the Community</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |              |                                          |                |                                          |
| 11. Baltimore Development Corporation should work with business owners to improve local retail establishments and the business environment. Examples include façade Improvements to corner stores at: these locations:<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>3939 Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>4001 Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>3401 Edmondson Ave</li> <li>423 Normandy Ave. at W. Franklin</li> </ul> | Short-Medium | BDC, Private, Community /businesses, DOP | \$\$           | Capital Budget, Grants, INSPIRE GO Bonds |
| 12. Work with the Baltimore Development Corporation to seek desired tenants at retail establishments.<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Edmondson Village Shopping Center</li> <li>Local corner stores</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                          | Short-Medium | BDC, DOP, Private, Community             | N/A            | N/A                                      |

## Create Environmentally-Sustainable Neighborhoods

| Recommendation & Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Timeframe    | Lead Responsibility                               | Estimated Cost              | Potential Funding                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>Beautify Highly-visible Public Spaces</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |                                                   |                             |                                               |
| 13. Create decorative landscape treatments along the edge of Gwynns Falls Leakin Park.<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Install wooden bollards and boulders at select locations along the parks edge</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                         | Ongoing      | BCRP, DOP HNI                                     | \$\$                        | Grants, Capital Budget                        |
| 14. Install new guardrails or wooden bollards along Gelston Drive from Denison to Edgewood Street.<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Install new guardrails or wooden bollards from Denison Street to Edgewood Street</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                          | Short        | DOT                                               | \$\$                        | Capital Budget                                |
| <b>Contribute to the Green Network through Lot Restoration</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |              |                                                   |                             |                                               |
| 15. Develop green reuse treatments for vacant lots.<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Alley lots at Loudon and W. Mulberry, Lyndhurst and W. Mulberry, and alley parcel behind 4000 Franklin Street</li> <li>Lot next to 748 Denison Street (City-owned)</li> <li>700 Denison Street (City-owned)</li> <li>501-503 Normandy (City-owned)</li> <li>Lot behind Edmondson Village Shopping Center</li> </ul> | Short-Medium | Community, DPW, HNI, DOP/ Sustainability, Private | \$\$-\$\$\$                 | Grants, Capital Budget, INSPIRE GO Bonds, GGI |
| 16. Beautify the triangular lot in the 600-block of N. Woodington Road with decorative treatments to honor military veterans.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Short        | Community, HNI, DOP                               | \$\$                        | Operating and Capital Budgets                 |
| 17. Increase the tree canopy in the community. In addition to along the primary routes, include:<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Allendale and Edmondson Ave. (NW Corner)</li> <li>Edmondson Ave. median</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                     | Short        | BCRP/Tree Baltimore, Community                    | N/A (already accounted for) | INSPIRE GO Bonds, Capital Budget              |
| 18. Expand Lyndhurst's efforts to become a green and sustainable school.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Short        | DOP/ Sustainability, School                       | N/A                         | N/A                                           |

## Create Opportunities for Health and Wellness

| Recommendation & Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Timeframe     | Lead Responsibility                | Estimated Cost | Potential Funding        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Improve and Create New Places for Play and Recreation in the Community</b>                                                                                                                                                                                        |               |                                    |                |                          |
| 19. Increase recreational programming for youth and area residents.                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Short-Medium  | <b>Community, BCRP</b>             | N/A            | Grants, Operating Budget |
| 20. Make improvements at the Edgewood Lyndhurst Recreation Center <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Renovate the tennis courts</li> <li>Increase parking at the Center</li> <li>Increase on-field lighting to illuminate the football field at night</li> </ul> | Medium-Long   | <b>BCRP</b>                        | \$\$\$         | Capital                  |
| 21. Recondition the baseball fields along the edge of Gwynns Falls Leakin Park. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>4100 Stokes Dr.</li> <li>4200 Seminole Ave.</li> </ul>                                                                                        | Medium        | <b>BCRP</b>                        | \$\$           | Capital                  |
| 22. Restore existing neighborhood playgrounds and courts. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Basketball court at Woodridge and Woodington Rd.</li> <li>Playground surface at 4200 Seminole Ave.</li> </ul>                                                       | Long          | <b>BCRP</b>                        | \$\$           | Capital                  |
| <b>Enhance the Healthy Food Environment</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |                                    |                |                          |
| 23. Develop and implement a comprehensive food access strategy.                                                                                                                                                                                                      |               |                                    |                |                          |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Provide transportation to the Giant</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                | Short-Ongoing | <b>Private, Community</b>          | TBD            | Private                  |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Explore opportunities for school families to receive nutrition education in the Giant</li> </ul>                                                                                                                              | Short-Ongoing | <b>City Schools/ Family League</b> | N/A            | N/A                      |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Promote the Farmers Market in Edmondson Village</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                    | Short-Ongoing | <b>Private</b>                     | N/A            | N/A                      |
| 24. Encourage healthy food retail, especially at corner stores near the school.                                                                                                                                                                                      | Ongoing       | <b>Private, DOH</b>                | N/A            | N/A                      |

## Improve Resident Safety

| Recommendation & Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Timeframe    | Lead Responsibility                 | Estimated Cost | Potential Funding          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Target Nuisance Corner Stores for Loitering and Crime</b>                                                                                                                                                                           |              |                                     |                |                            |
| 25. Reduce nuisances caused by corner stores. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>3401 Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>3730 Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>3939 Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>4001 Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>801 Woodington Rd.</li> </ul> | Ongoing      | <b>HCD,BCPD, Community CLC, BDC</b> | \$             | Private                    |
| <b>Reduce Crime through Community-based Activities, Environmental Design, and Partnerships</b>                                                                                                                                         |              |                                     |                |                            |
| 26. Partner with the Southwest Police District to increase community policing and neighborhood visibility.                                                                                                                             | Ongoing      | <b>BCPD, Community</b>              | N/A            | Operating                  |
| 27. Use crime prevention design principles to enhance safety.                                                                                                                                                                          | Short-Medium | <b>BCPD, DOP, Community</b>         | TBD            | Operating, Capital, Grants |

## Improve Sanitation

| Recommendation & Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Timeframe | Lead Responsibility | Estimated Cost | Potential Funding              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------------------|----------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Keep the Neighborhood Clean</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |           |                     |                |                                |
| 28. Increase and target enforcement efforts in areas known for trash, illegal dumping, and rodents. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Alley behind the 700-block of Denison Street (even side)</li> <li>Rear of Edmondson Village Shopping Center</li> <li>Areas along the edges of Gwynns Falls Park at Gelston and Edgewood, Gelston and Stokes Dr., and Seminole and Rokeby Rd.</li> <li>Eastern edge of Edmondson High School near the cemetery (along the fence)</li> </ul> | Short     | HCD, DPW            | N/A            | Operating, Capital             |
| 29. Install bollards at the back end of alley intersection of Denison Street and N. Hilton Street to prevent chronic dumping near the wall.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Short     | DOT                 | \$-\$\$        | Capital, Motor Vehicle Revenue |

## Create Connections and Access

| Recommendation & Actions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Timeframe    | Lead Responsibility | Estimated Cost | Potential Funding     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------------|----------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Improve Traffic Conditions, Pedestrian Safety, and Walkability</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |              |                     |                |                       |
| 30. Create a “walking school bus,” “bicycle train,” or “block captain” program.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Ongoing      | School, Community   | N/A            | N/A                   |
| 31. Make Edmondson Avenue safer for pedestrians. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Reduce speed limit on Edmondson Ave. near school to 25 MPH</li> <li>Install travel speed indicators on Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>Paint yellow street line markings beside the curbs in the street on Edmondson Ave.</li> <li>Install new pedestrian crosswalks on both sides of Loudon Ave. and Lyndhurst St.</li> <li>Install decorative pedestrian safety bollards in 4000-block of Edmondson Ave. at Wildwood Pkwy.</li> </ul>     | Short        | DOT                 | \$\$\$         | Motor Vehicle Revenue |
| 32. Explore ways to accommodate safe bicycle travel to school and in the neighborhood.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Short-Medium | DOT                 | TBD            | TBD                   |
| 33. Provide additional transportation enhancements around Lyndhurst. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Provide new bus stop bench and/or shelter at Allendale and Edmondson Ave., and new benches at Edmondson and Wildwood Pkwy and Edmondson and Hilton St.</li> <li>Plant ornamental trees and shrubs along Edmondson Ave. median</li> <li>Landscape the Wildwood Pkwy median including tree trimming, planters, and flowers</li> <li>Beautify the Edmondson Ave. corridor, including decorative banners</li> </ul> | Short        | DOT                 | \$-\$\$        | TBD                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Short        | BCRP                | \$-\$\$        | TBD                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Short        | BCRP, Community     | \$             | TBD                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Short        | HNI, BDC, Community | S              | TBD                   |



# *Appendix A: Maps*

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**Housing Market Typology**

**Zoning**

**Proposed Edmondson Village  
National Register Historic District**

**Vacant Properties**

**Tree Planting Sites**

**Food Environment**

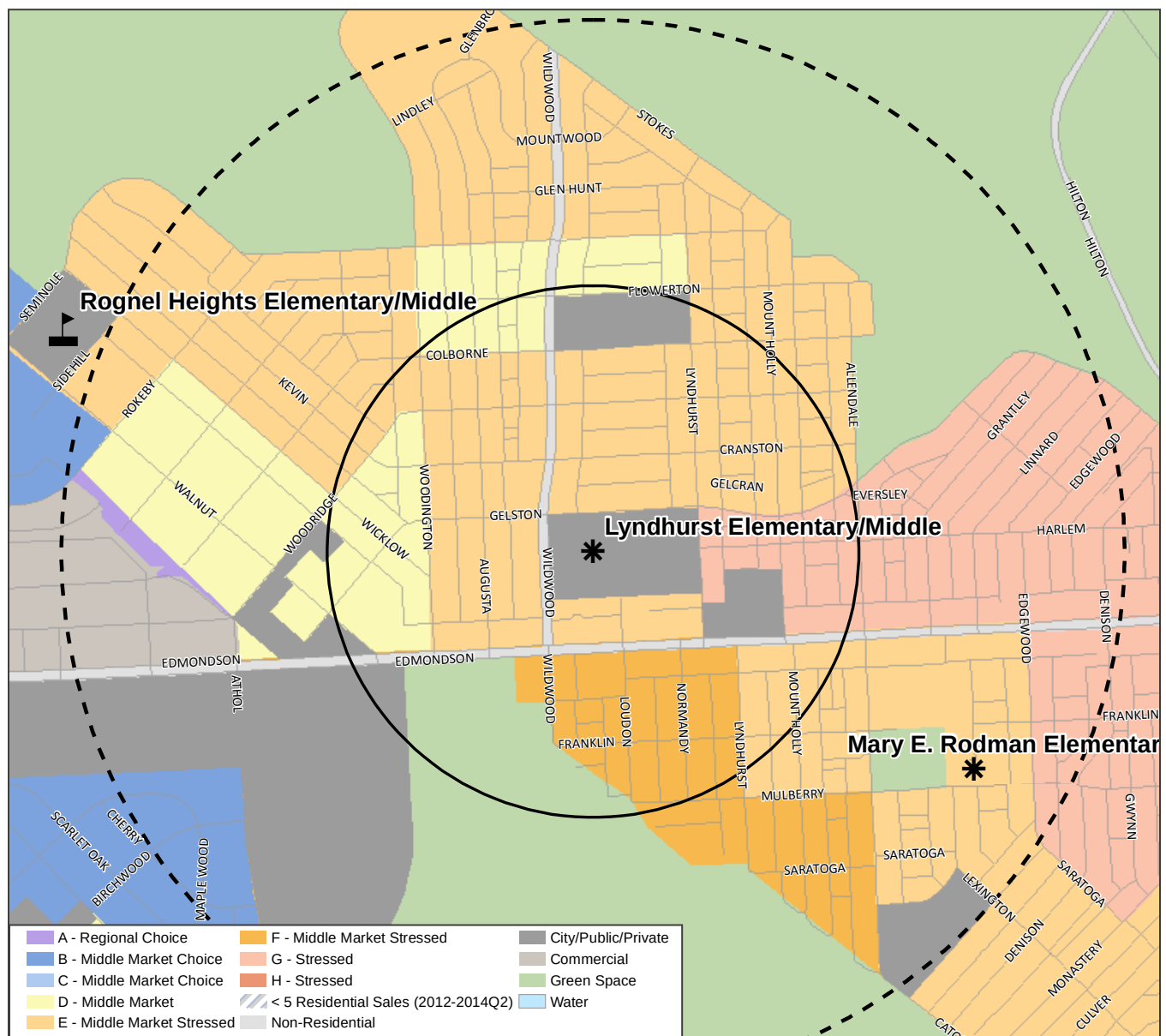
**Part 1 Crime Incidents**

**Code Enforcement Zones**

**311 Calls - Dirty Streets and Alleys**

## Housing Market Typology

Neighborhood market conditions affect most neighborhood change strategies city governments, community development corporations, or others would like to pursue. For goals to be met – whether to improve the quality of rental housing, foster reuse of vacant properties, attract commercial development, etc. – interested parties must take into account local market conditions. Market conditions are not the only factor to consider, but they can help inform activities that will have the greatest positive impact. Baltimore’s housing market typology was developed to assist the City in its efforts to strategically match available public resources to neighborhood housing market conditions. The typology is also used to inform local neighborhood planning and activities by helping residents understand the housing market forces impacting their communities. The 2014 update of the City’s Housing Market Typology was jointly developed by the Baltimore City Planning Department, the Department of Housing and Community Development (HCD), and The Reinvestment Fund. This map identifies market conditions around Lyndhurst Elementary/Middle School.



Neighborhoods in the **Regional Choice** market category represent competitive housing markets with high owner-occupancy rates and high property values in comparison to all other market types. Foreclosure, vacancy and abandonment rates are low. Market interventions are not necessary in the Regional Choice market, but basic municipal services such as street maintenance are essential to maintaining these markets.

Neighborhoods in the **Middle Market Choice** category have housing prices above the city's average with strong ownership rates, and low vacancies, but with slightly increased foreclosure rates. Modest incentives and strong neighborhood marketing should keep these communities healthy, with the potential for growth.

Neighborhoods in the **Middle Market** category have median sales values above the City's average, as well as high homeownership rates. These markets experienced higher foreclosure rates when compared to higher value markets, with slight population loss. Interventions are geared toward aggressive code enforcement, in an effort to move vacant buildings as quickly as possible to rehabilitation, which in turn supports existing homeowners. Significant portions of the Middle Market spectrum are covered by Streamlined Code Enforcement.

Neighborhoods in the **Middle Market Stressed** category have slightly lower home sale values than the City's average, and have not shown significant sales price appreciation. Vacancies and foreclosure rates are high, and the rate of population loss has increased

in this market type, according to the 2010 Census data. Based on these market conditions, intervention strategies should support homeowners who may be facing economic hardships due to the national economy. These communities often have under-appreciated assets such as historic housing stock, significant park spaces and choice locations that can serve as building blocks for future revitalization efforts.

Neighborhoods in the **Stressed** category have experienced significant deterioration of the housing stock. This market category contains the highest vacancy rates and the lowest home ownership rates, compared to the other market types. It also has experienced some of the most substantial population losses in the city during the past decade. Comprehensive housing market interventions should be targeted in this market category, including site assembly, tax increment financing, and concentrated demolitions to create potential for greater public safety and new green amenities. Support for stable residential blocks is also necessary.

*The INSPIRE represents a fairly typical "mixed" Middle Market neighborhood. While much of the area is categorized as Middle Market Stressed, there are pockets of stronger markets throughout, including areas of Middle Market Choice on the edges of the one-half mile. The blocks directly west of the school start to see a weaker housing market.*

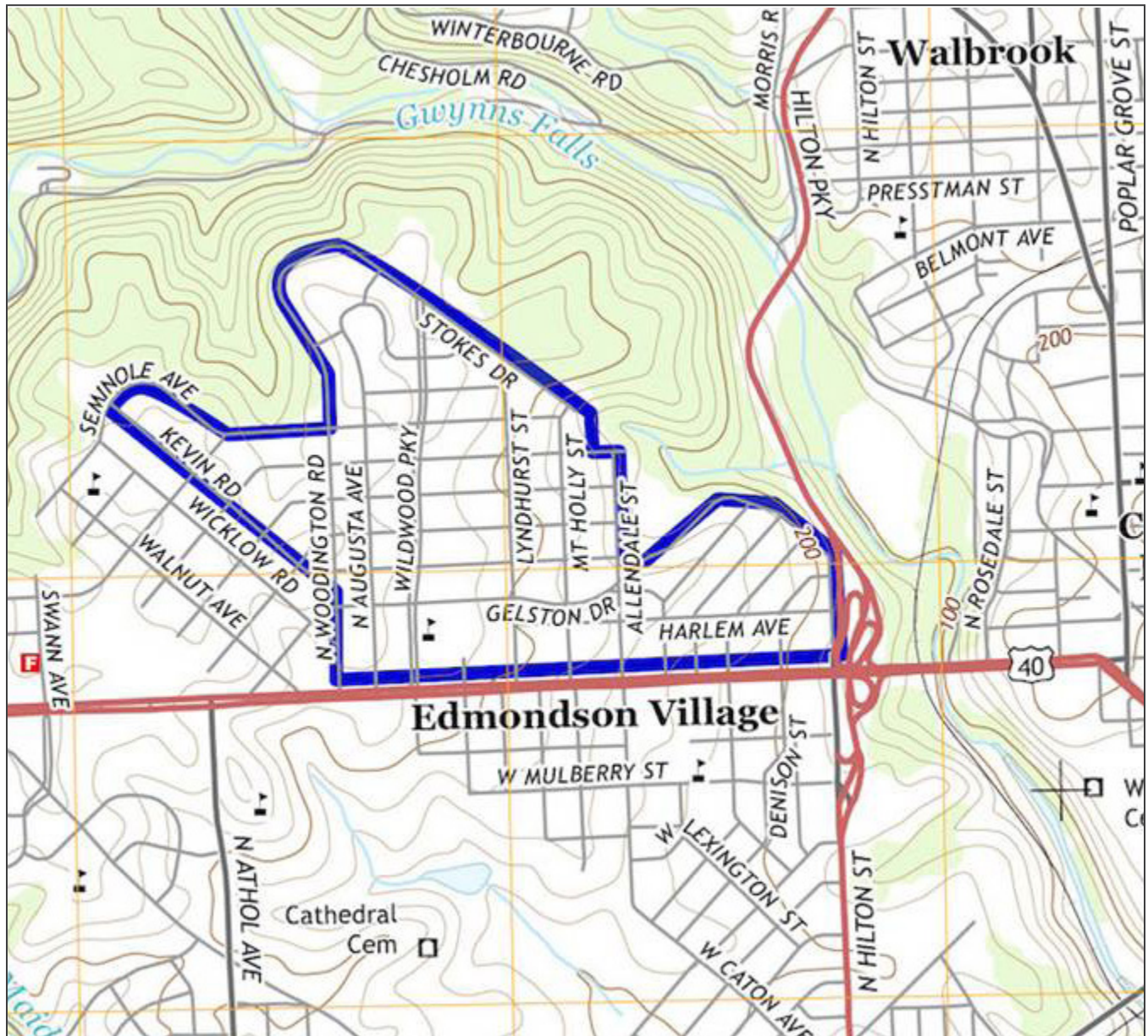


It illustrates a more accurate depiction of land uses in the area.

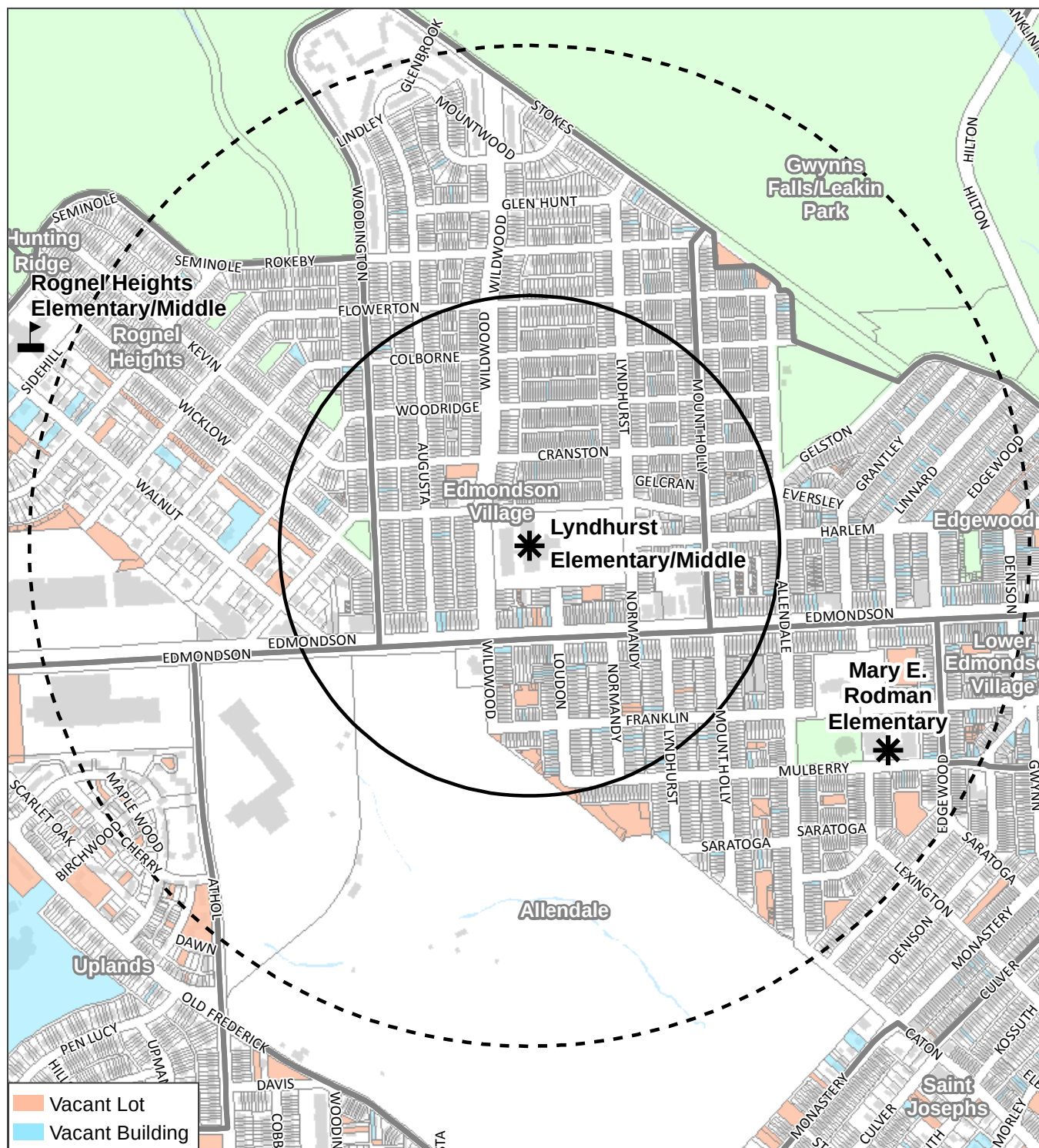




## Proposed Edmondson Village National Register Historic District



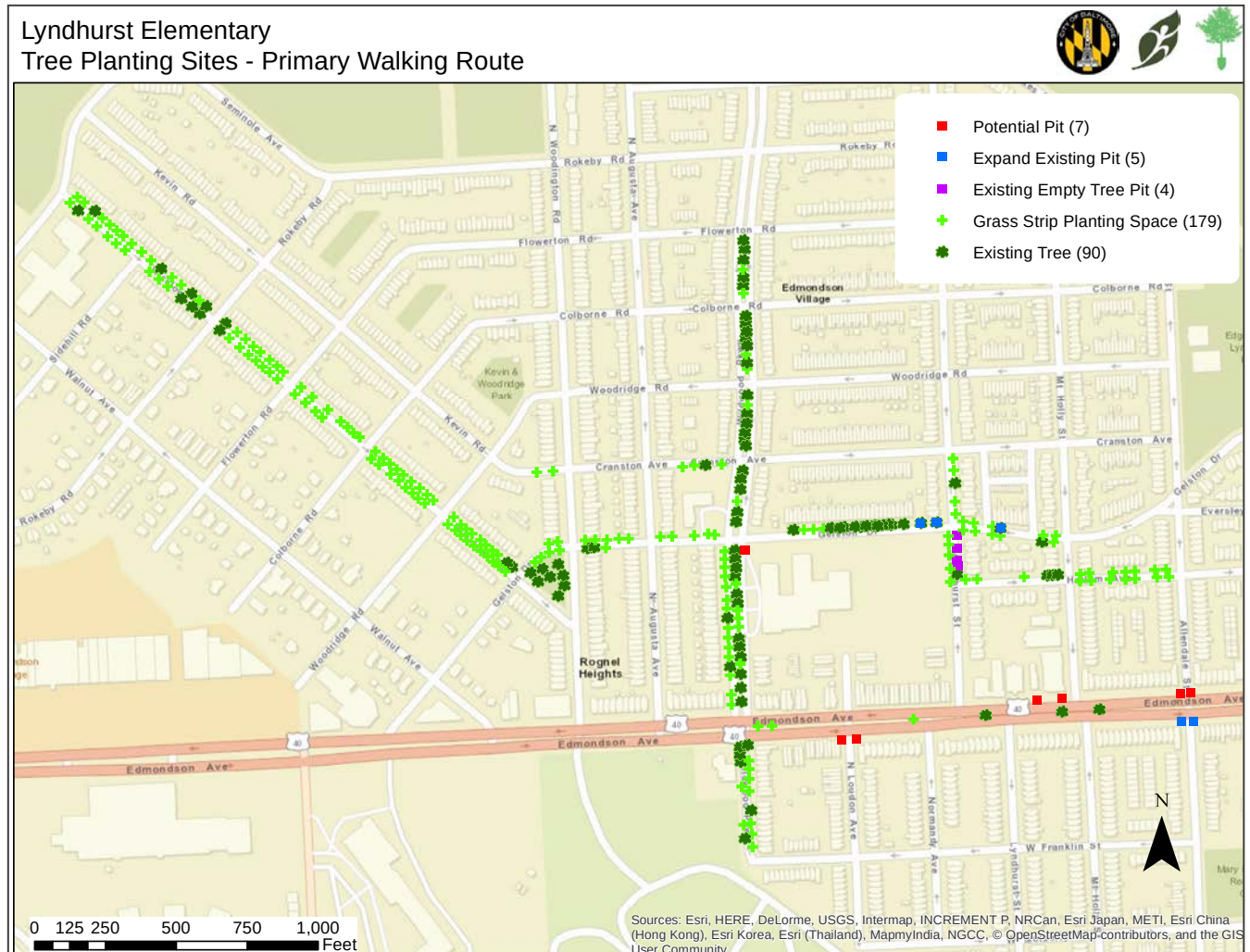
This map shows vacant lots and buildings.





## Tree Planting Sites

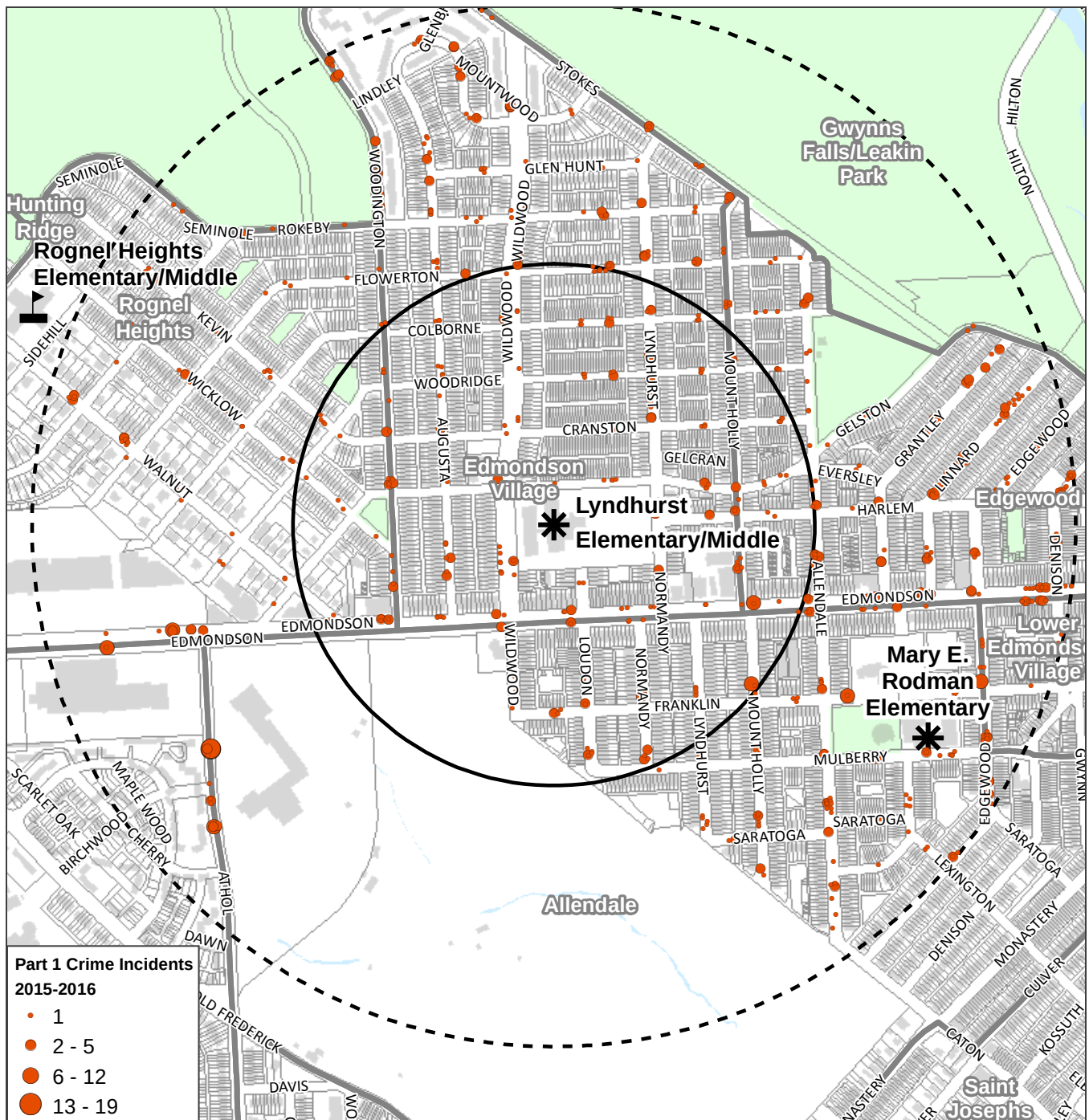
This map shows potential tree planting sites, as assessed by TreeBaltimore.  
Further assessment will take place to determine final sites.





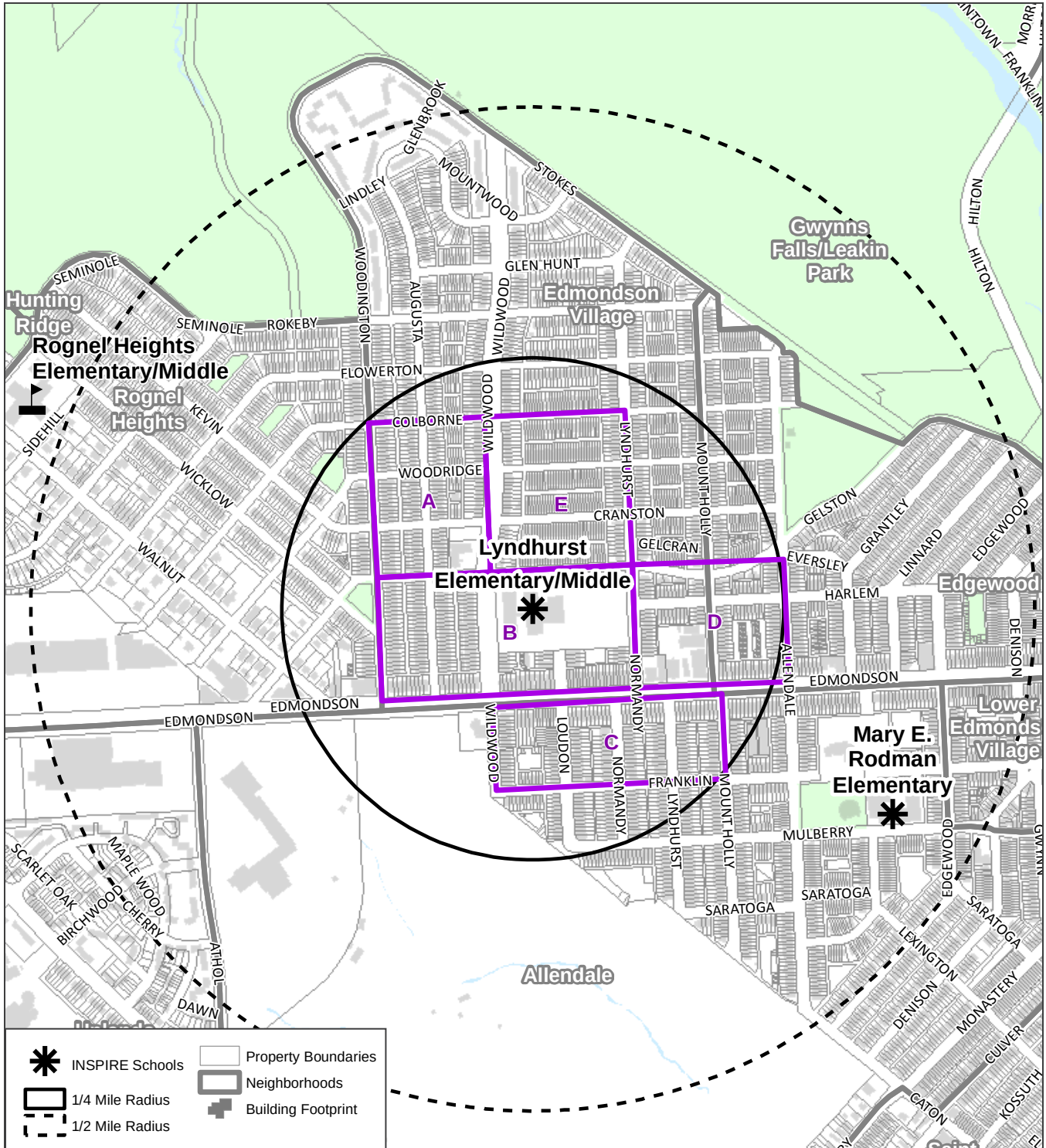


Part 1 crimes are incidents of homicide, rape, aggravated assault, arson, robbery, burglary, larceny, and auto theft.



## Code Enforcement Zones

This map shows the Code Enforcement Zones designated by HCD for within the quarter-mile INSPIRE area. *This map is being updated.*







## *Appendix B: Public Input*

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**Between October 2014 and February 2017, Department of Planning Staff met with members of the school communities and neighborhood residents to better understand their neighborhood experiences, concerns, and needs. The following is a summary of stakeholder comments collected from community workshops, student workshops, and surveys.**



**INSPIRE Workshops: October 11, 2014 and January 28, 2015**

Nineteen people participated in the first INSPIRE workshop, and 34 people participated in the second, including representatives from the school, neighborhood, stakeholder organizations, and the City. The following **Strengths (S)**, **Weaknesses (W)**, and **Opportunities (O)** were recorded:

| <i>Community</i>      |                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>S</b>              | Strong community leaders                                                                               |
| <b>S</b>              | Churches in the community                                                                              |
| <b>S</b>              | Youth – Approach that positively channels energy                                                       |
| <b>S</b>              | Edmondson Village library                                                                              |
| <b>S</b>              | 40 West Clergy Association                                                                             |
| <b>W</b>              | Lack of art & cultural programs                                                                        |
| <b>W</b>              | Trash – garbage pickup (alleys – spot enforcement)                                                     |
| <b>W</b>              | Need more afterschool activities and study places                                                      |
| <b>W</b>              | Loss of Head Start                                                                                     |
| <b>W</b>              | Territorial neighborhood boundary issues                                                               |
| <b>W</b>              | Ex-offender employment                                                                                 |
| <b>W</b>              | Perception of crime                                                                                    |
| <b>W</b>              | Litter- Junk food packaging                                                                            |
| <b>O</b>              | Study hall at churches for students                                                                    |
| <b>O</b>              | Residents are concerned about what will happen to the recreation center space at Rognel Heights School |
| <b>O</b>              | Change neighborhood dynamics into positive energy                                                      |
| <b>O</b>              | Survey youth and students for activities                                                               |
| <b>O</b>              | Neighborhood Leadership Academy                                                                        |
| <b>O</b>              | Create a 501 (c)(4) (federal and charitable resources)                                                 |
| <b>O</b>              | New young families choose Edmondson Village as choice neighborhood                                     |
| <b>O</b>              | More trash cans                                                                                        |
| <i>Transportation</i> |                                                                                                        |
| <b>S</b>              | Red Line Light Rail Transit Line                                                                       |
| <b>W</b>              | Walkability for seniors                                                                                |
| <b>W</b>              | 3400 Gelston sidewalks                                                                                 |
| <b>W</b>              | Edmondson Avenue and Lyndhurst (walkability)                                                           |
| <b>W</b>              | Alley behind 700-block of Denison – poor access, lighting, configuration; weeds; trash                 |
| <b>W</b>              | Need to resurface Edmondson Village Shopping Center lot                                                |
| <b>O</b>              | Additional parking at Edgewood Lyndhurst Recreation Center                                             |
| <b>O</b>              | Have Lyndhurst 5th graders conduct walkability tours                                                   |

|                                         |                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b><i>Housing</i></b>                   |                                                                                                           |
| <b>S</b>                                | Homeownership (well-kept homes)                                                                           |
| <b>W</b>                                | Need more code enforcement                                                                                |
| <b>W</b>                                | 4000 Edmondson Avenue – extremely blighted vacant house                                                   |
| <b>W</b>                                | Blighted alley garages & weeds (interior alley – Allendale, Edmondson, Harlem, Mt. Holly)                 |
| <b>W</b>                                | 700 Grantley Street – overgrown weeds, vines on power lines, rats                                         |
| <b>W</b>                                | Overgrown weeds at rear of school on top of hill on Lyndhurst Avenue                                      |
| <b>O</b>                                | Need to engage Healthy Neighborhoods                                                                      |
| <b>O</b>                                | Help renters transition to homeownership                                                                  |
| <b>O</b>                                | Establish more 501(c)(3) & 501 (c)(4) organizations to purchase vacant housing                            |
| <b>O</b>                                | Market neighborhood through Live Baltimore with pictures, stories, neighborhood profiles, and ambassadors |
| <b>O</b>                                | Explore possible land trusts                                                                              |
| <b>O</b>                                | Promote as 1st Home Community for new homeowners                                                          |
| <b>O</b>                                | Provide resources for homeowners                                                                          |
| <b>O</b>                                | Senior home repairs                                                                                       |
| <b>O</b>                                | Façade improvement grants                                                                                 |
| <b>O</b>                                | Energy challenge assistance                                                                               |
| <b>O</b>                                | Housing should institute a zone plan/strategy targeting 4 hotspots/quadrants around Lyndhurst             |
| <b>O</b>                                | DPW Special Investigative Unit to look at dumping behind 700-block of Denison and area near Stokes Dr.    |
| <b><i>Recreation and Open Space</i></b> |                                                                                                           |
| <b>S</b>                                | Athletic fields in parks                                                                                  |
| <b>W</b>                                | Trash at the Edgewood Lyndhurst Recreation Center                                                         |
| <b>W</b>                                | Edgewood Lyndhurst Recreation Center is unsafe at night and needs more light                              |
| <b>W</b>                                | Edgewood Lyndhurst Rec. Ctr. not well linked to the community (programs not attractive to community)      |
| <b>W</b>                                | Dirt bike enforcement                                                                                     |
| <b>O</b>                                | Fields along parks edge should be used for more active recreation                                         |
| <b>O</b>                                | 700-block of Denison – Vacant Lot                                                                         |
| <b>O</b>                                | Amateur Boxing Gym                                                                                        |
| <b>O</b>                                | Survey Residents for new uses at recreation center                                                        |
| <b>O</b>                                | Engage youth ages 11-18 (uniformed, organized, and supervised sports)                                     |
| <b>O</b>                                | Need additional programs at recreation center                                                             |
| <b>O</b>                                | Athletic programs for existing fields and courts                                                          |
| <b>O</b>                                | Community Pool at Recreation Center of Edmondson High School                                              |
| <b><i>Commercial Development</i></b>    |                                                                                                           |
| <b>S</b>                                | Giant grocery Store                                                                                       |
| <b>W</b>                                | Poor appearance of Edmondson Village Shopping Center                                                      |
| <b>W</b>                                | Edmondson Village corner stores                                                                           |
| <b>W</b>                                | 742 Edgewood corner store – side of house entrance                                                        |
| <b>W</b>                                | Edmondson Village Shopping Center - mix of stores                                                         |
| <b>O</b>                                | Farmers Market in the area – at or near Rec Center or Skills Center lot                                   |
| <b>O</b>                                | Target Improvements at corner stores                                                                      |
| <b>O</b>                                | Corner Store code enforcement                                                                             |
| <b>O</b>                                | Revitalization of the Edmondson Village Shopping Center                                                   |

## Community Survey Responses

These are results of a survey administered to student parents, family members, teachers, and community members.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b><i>Community</i></b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>35% of the survey respondents thought that Edmondson Village was a good (2%) or very good (2%) place to raise children. 48% thought it was a fair place to raise children, an 17% of the respondents didn't answer this question. No one answering the question rated it as poor or very poor.</b>                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| We have nice neighbors. We all get along and look out for each other.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Family. Most of my neighbors homes were passed down from generations. Grandparents, great grandparents, parents, children, aunts, uncles, cousins occupy most of the homes. Everyone knows everyone else. |
| Add more activities for the kids after school.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | More after school programs; more summer programs; more things for our children to do all year round.                                                                                                      |
| <b><i>Transportation</i></b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>74% of the respondents' households own a vehicle.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>How do you get around (for work, school, social activities, worship, etc.)?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Walking: 28%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Public transportation: 17%                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Driving alone: 52%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Carpooling: 14%                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Taking a taxi: 10%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Other: 7% (hack, kids drive)                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b><i>Transportation</i></b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>How safe do you feel walking around in your neighborhood?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Very safe: 10%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Unsafe: 10%                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Safe: 55%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Very unsafe: 17%                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| No answer: 7%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b><i>Recreation &amp; Open Space</i></b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Student comments, collected through student workshops with 3rd through 5th graders at Lyndhurst Elementary School and Rog-nel Heights Elementary School (to be closed), focused largely on recreation and open space. Of the 37 students who completed the worksheet, over 50% stated that some type of play space is their favorite place in the neighborhood. |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>What is your favorite place in the neighborhood?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Home/backyard: 35%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Park: 2%                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Store: 6%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Playground/Courts/Field: 19%                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Rec Center: 5%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Other: 8%                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>What is your least favorite place in the neighborhood?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Park: 16%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | School: 8%                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Shopping Center/Stores: 14%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Alleys/Block: 24%                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Playground: 5%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Other or no answer: 33%                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>What do you like to do in the neighborhood?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Play in the park: 8%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Facilities play: 15%                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| General play (ride bikes, play with friends, etc.): 69%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Other or no answer: 8%                                                                                                                                                                                    |

| If you could add one thing to the neighborhood, what would it be?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 69% of the students responded that they would add things to increase access and quality of play, including a better playground, a recreation center every three blocks, a 90-foot park, a free basketball team, bigger space where kids and adults can hang out, and a swimming pool. The results from the parent/resident surveys closely echoed the desires of the students. |                                                                                |
| Recreation facility: 19%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Park/Open space: 19%                                                           |
| Playground: 16%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Pool: 6%                                                                       |
| Housing: 8%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | More schools: 19%                                                              |
| Shopping center: 3%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Nothing or no answer: 24%                                                      |
| Having access to participate in the rec activities for low-income students in the summer.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | I would like to see more things for our seniors and young persons in the area. |
| More places for the kids to play, like a rec, etc.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Activities that children want to participate in and enjoy.                     |



# *Appendix C: Programs & Initiatives*

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**Appendix C contains information about, and links to, the programs and initiatives mentioned in this plan.**

**Baltimarket Healthy Corner Store Program** works with store owners and with communities to make healthy food available in corner stores. The Healthy Corner Store Program is a part of Baltimarket, a suite of community-based food access and food justice programs through the Baltimore City Health Department (BCHD).

[www.baltimarket.org/healthy-corner-stores/](http://www.baltimarket.org/healthy-corner-stores/)

**Baltimore Food Policy Initiative (BFPI)** is an intergovernmental collaboration between the Department of Planning, Office of Sustainability, Baltimore City Health Department, and Baltimore Development Corporation. It was founded in 2010 to “improve health outcomes by increasing access to healthy affordable food in Baltimore City’s food deserts”. With each agency lending its expertise, the City creates comprehensive strategies that tackle food access from many perspectives, and implements programs and policies with multi-sector support. Interested parties can contact BFPI through the Planning Department to learn more about food-related issues in Baltimore.

[www.baltimoresustainability.org/projects/baltimore-food-policy-initiative/](http://www.baltimoresustainability.org/projects/baltimore-food-policy-initiative/)

The **Baltimore Housing** website provides information about many programs and incentives, including homebuyer incentives, weatherization and energy efficiency programs, and more.

<http://www.baltimorehousing.org/>

**The Commission for Historical and Architectural Preservation (CHAP)** helps preserve and revitalize neighborhoods, celebrates City history, and promotes historic preservation as a proven economic driver for Baltimore City. It was established in 1964, and is currently governed by Article Six of the Baltimore City Code. Today CHAP oversees 33 local historic districts, over 200 landmarks, and manages a local historic preservation tax credit program. CHAP The mayoral appointed Commission and its staff are located within the Department of Planning.

<http://chap.baltimorecity.gov/>

**The Community Law Center** is Maryland’s only legal services organization dedicated solely to strengthening neighborhoods and the nonprofit sector. The Community Law Center empowers communities and nonprofits that lack the financial resources to pay for private legal representation. Through their programs, they have assisted in the growth of hundreds of community associations and nonprofits, facilitated the revitalization of blighted land and vacant structures, reduced crime and nuisance activities stemming from residential and commercial properties, and helped communities and nonprofits accomplish their goals and achieve their missions.

<http://communitylaw.org/>

**Community-Wealth.org** has compiled a range of information about community development corporations, which may be useful to individuals interested in exploring the possibility of starting a CDC.

<http://community-wealth.org/strategies/panel/cdcs/index.html>

**Cooking Matters in the Store** helps families make healthy and affordable choices at the supermarket. This program teaches parents and caregivers to stretch their food dollar and provide their families good nutrition is a critical part of ending childhood hunger in America.

<https://extension.umd.edu/fsne/fsne-adult-programs/cooking-matters%C2%AE-store>

**Crime Prevention through Environmental Design (CPTED)** is a multidisciplinary approach to deterring criminal behavior that focuses on changing how places are laid out, and how they look and feel. Basic principles include “natural surveillance,” and “territoriality,” which looks at how signage and maintenance suggest that a space is cared for. According to the Local Initiative’s Support Corporation’s Community Safety Initiative, good use of CPTED requires input from multiple people, including users of a space who might have varied perceptions of what makes it feel scary or safe, as well as property managers, community developers, and law enforcement personnel who bring different information and resources to conversations about crime.

<http://www.cpted.net>

**Engaged Presence Produces Reduction** is a strategy employed by the Baltimore City Police Department’s Community Collaboration Division. According to its website, the Community Collaboration Division’s mission is to develop strategies that produce col-

laborative partnerships between law enforcement, Baltimore City residents, faith-based organizations, businesses, schools, media, other government agencies and non-profit organizations.

<https://www.baltimorepolice.org/community-collaboration>

**The Green Network Plan** will be a collective vision for Baltimore to revitalize communities by creating an interconnected system of greenspaces throughout the city. The planning process will bring together City agencies, residents, neighborhood partners and Baltimore businesses to transform vacant properties into community assets such as recreation areas, trails, and urban gardens.

<http://www.baltimoresustainability.org/projects/green-network/>

**The Growing Green Initiative** is a City-led effort to use sustainable, innovative, and cost-effective practices for stabilizing and holding land for redevelopment, and reusing vacant land to green neighborhoods, reduce stormwater runoff, grow food, and create community spaces that mitigate the negative impacts of vacant properties and set the stage for growing Baltimore. It is run through the Office of Sustainability.

[www.baltimoresustainability.org/projects/growing-green-initiative/](http://www.baltimoresustainability.org/projects/growing-green-initiative/)

**Healthy Neighborhoods, Inc.** helps strong but undervalued Baltimore neighborhoods increase home values, market their communities, create high standards for property improvements, and forge strong connections among neighbors. The initiative provides capital for rehabilitation and purchase of homes, funding community-based projects, marketing neighborhoods to homebuyers and developers, and creating partnerships between neighborhood organizations, non-profits, and lenders. The Edmondson Village Healthy Neighborhoods liaison is located in the Go-Northwest office in Northwest Baltimore.

[www.healthyneighborhoods.org/](http://www.healthyneighborhoods.org/)

The **LIGHT Program (Leading Innovation for a Green and Healthy Tomorrow)**, led by Baltimore Housing, is the central application intake, referral, and processing program for the City's Weatherization program, Office of Rehabilitation Services, and Lead Hazard Reduction Program. LIGHT also refers clients to over 300 possible other city, state, local NGO programs and services based on the application screening process. LIGHT provides comprehensive benefits screenings and case management to coordinate housing, energy conservation, health, safety and financial services to Baltimore families.

[http://www.baltimorehousing.org/ghsh\\_light](http://www.baltimorehousing.org/ghsh_light)

**Live Baltimore** helps people find a place that they can call home in Baltimore by gathering resources, simplifying information, researching money-saving incentives, and offering firsthand knowledge about the city with the goal of cultivating and maintaining thriving neighborhoods.

<https://livebaltimore.com/>

The **Neighborhood Design Center** provides access to pro bono design services in underserved communities in Baltimore City and Prince George's County, MD. In collaboration with neighborhood groups, local government agencies and fellow nonprofits, we support locally driven initiatives for neighborhoods pursuing improved quality of life within their built environments. NDC has helped communities build new playgrounds, reclaim vacant lots and abandoned buildings, revitalize commercial districts, create community master plans, and beautify their neighborhoods.

<http://www.ndc-md.org/>

**Office of Sustainability – Green, Healthy, Smart Challenge Grant** is a grant program for student-led sustainability projects in Baltimore City Public Schools. Students must be a part of an organized green team that meets to complete their project. The aim is to have projects encourage and assist schools in reaching Maryland Green School Certification.

<http://www.baltimoresustainability.org/projects/green-schools-initiative/green-healthy-smart-challenge/>

**One House at a Time** acts as a court-appointed, non-profit agent to convey, raze or rehabilitate vacant and nuisance properties thereby creating safer, more stable neighborhoods.

<http://www.onehousebaltimore.org/>

**Project C.O.R.E. (Creating Opportunities for Renewal and Enterprise)** is a partnership between the Maryland Department of Housing and Community Development, the Maryland Stadium Authority, and the Baltimore City Department of Housing and Community Development to demolish thousands of vacant buildings, which will serve as the catalyst for redevelopment, reinvestment, and stabilization in Baltimore. The initiative will generate jobs, strengthen the partnership between the City of Baltimore and the State of Maryland and lead to safer, healthier and more attractive spaces for families to live and put down roots.

<http://dhcd.maryland.gov/ProjectCORE/Pages/default.aspx>

**Safe Routes to School** programs operate throughout the country, including here in Baltimore City and throughout the state of Maryland. The purpose of this program is to substantially improve safety for students in grades K-8 who walk and bike to school. The three main goals of the program are: to enable and encourage children, including those with disabilities, to walk and bike to school; to make biking and walking to school a safer and more appealing transportation choice, thereby encouraging a healthy and active lifestyle from an early age; and to aid the planning and building of projects and activities that will improve safety and reduce traffic, fuel consumption, and air pollution nearby primary and middle schools.

**St. Ambrose Housing Aid Center** provides comprehensive housing services and quality affordable homes to meet the challenges facing homeowners, renters and neighborhoods in the Baltimore area.

<https://www.stambros.org/>

**TreeBaltimore** serves as the umbrella organization for all City agencies, private organizations and individuals in their effort to increase the tree canopy of Baltimore. TreeBaltimore strives to increase the urban tree canopy through the establishment, management and preservation of trees. To reach our goal of 40% tree canopy cover by 2037, we partner with individual homeowners as well as communities, schools, and businesses. TreeBaltimore is a mayoral initiative led by the Baltimore City of Recreation and Parks in partnership with Blue Water Baltimore, the Parks & People Foundation, Baltimore Tree Trust and the Alliance for the Chesapeake Bay.

<http://treebaltimore.org/>

**Vacants to Value** is a City initiative to clean up and redevelop vacant properties, help raise property values, create community amenities, increase local tax revenue, and attract new residents and businesses.

<http://www.vacantstovalue.org/>

A **walking school bus** is a group of children walking to school with one or more adults. That may sound simple, and that is part of the appeal. It can be as informal as two families taking turns walking their children to school or as structured as a planned route with meeting points, a timetable and a schedule of trained volunteers. A variation on the walking school bus is a bicycle train where a group of children and adult leaders ride together to school.

[http://guide.saferoutesinfo.org/walking\\_school\\_bus/](http://guide.saferoutesinfo.org/walking_school_bus/)